PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT (PWS)
DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS
Office of Information & Technology
Infrastructure Operations

Application Services

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Contents

1.0 BACKGROUND 4
2.0 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS 5
3.0 SCOPE OF WORK 5
3.1 APPLICABILITY ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**
3.2 ORDER TYPE ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**
4.0 PERFORMANCE DETAILS 7
4.1 PERFORMANCE PERIOD 7
4.2 PLACE OF PERFORMANCE 8
4.3 TRAVEL 8
5.0 SPECIFIC TASKS AND DELIVERABLES 8
5.1 PROJECT MANAGEMENT ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**
5.2 IDENTITY, CREDENTIAL AND ACCESS MANAGEMENT 9
5.2.1 ICAM SERVICES AGILE PRODUCT DELIVERY AND OPERATIONS 12
5.2.1.1 ACTIVE DIRECTORY PRODUCT DELIVERY AND OPERATIONS (OPTIONAL TASK) 16
5.2.2 ICAM CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE AND CHANGE MANAGEMENT 16
5.2.3 ICAM ENTERPRISE PROGRAM MANAGEMENT ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**
5.2.4 ICAM INNOVATION SUPPORT 19
5.2.5 DIGITAL IDENTITY RISK MANAGEMENT 19
5.2.6 IDENTITY, SECURITY, AND DATA INTEGRATION RISK, REMEDIATION, COMPLIANCE, AND POLICY SUPPORT 20
5.2.7 IDENTITY GOVERNANCE AND ADMINISTRATION (IGA) MODERNIZATION (OPTIONAL TASK) 21
5.2.8 ACTIVE DIRECTORY MODERNIZATION PLANNING (OPTIONAL TASK) 23
5.3 INFRASTRUCTURE CYBERSECURITY MANAGEMENT 24
5.3.1 RISK MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK AND AUTHORIZATION SUPPORT 24
5.3.2 KNOWN EXPLOITED VULNERABILITY (KEV) AND VULNERABILITY MANAGEMENT 28
5.3.2.1 CYBERSECURITY POSTURE EVALUATION 28
5.3.2.2 VA PARTNERSHIP ENGAGEMENT 30
5.3.2.3 VULNERABILITY MANAGEMENT SUPPORT 31
5.3.2.4 CYBERSECURITY METRICS AND COMMUNICATIONS 32
5.3.3 ENTERPRISE COMMON CONTROL SOLUTIONS 33
5.3.4 BUSINESS CONTINUITY MANAGEMENT PROGRAM PLANNING SUPPORT 35
5.3.5 NETWORK SECURITY SERVICE (NSS) 38
5.3.5.2 CONFIGURATION AND TUNING 40
5.3.5.3 NEW DEPLOYMENTS 41
5.3.5.4 DAY-TO-DAY OPERATION SUPPORT 42
5.3.5.5 VISIBILITY REQUIREMENTS 43
5.4 CERTIFICATE MANAGEMENT/PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE 44
5.5 WEB INFRASTRUCTURE AND ADMINISTRATION 46

DRAFT

5.5.1 WEBOPS SUPPORT 46
5.6 MIDDLEWARE SUPPORT 48
5.6.1 ORACLE WEBLOGIC MIDDLEWARE OPERATIONAL SUPPORT 48
5.6.2 MIDDLEWARE FILE TRANSFER SUPPORT 49
5.7 APPLICATION VIRTUALIZATION 50
5.8 PRINTER SECURITY MANAGEMENT 53
5.9 DATABASE ADMINISTRATION 56
5.9.1 NORMAL SHIFT DATABASE ADMINISTRATION 56
5.9.2 AFTER HOURS DATABASE ADMINISTRATION 59
5.10 OPERATIONS CONTROL/CONSOLIDATED MAIL OUTPATIENT PHARMACY (OC/CMOP) 61
5.10.1 CMOP DATABASE SUPPORT 61
5.10.2 OPERATIONS CONTROL 63
5.10.2.1 PRINT AND MAIL OPERATIONS SUPPORT 63
5.10.2.2 DATABASE SUPPORT FOR PPO & OC INTEGRATED SYSTEMS 68
5.10.2.3 MANAGED FILE TRANSFER (MFT) SYSTEM / SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & SUPPORT 73
5.11 SURGE SUPPORT (OPTIONAL TASK) 79
6.0 GENERAL REQUIREMENTS 80
6.1 SECURITY AND PRIVACY REQUIREMENTS 80
6.2 GOVERNMENT FURNISHED PROPERTY 81

DRAFT

1.0 BACKGROUND

The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) Office of Information and Technology (OIT), through its Infrastructure Operations (IO) organization, is responsible for delivering secure, reliable, and modern IT services that enable VA to fulfill its mission of providing healthcare and benefits to Veterans. IO supports a vast and complex enterprise environment spanning on-premises data centers, hybrid cloud platforms, and distributed systems serving millions of users including Veterans, employees, and partners. These services underpin mission-critical systems such as electronic health records, claims processing, benefits administration, cybersecurity, and enterprise-wide communications.

To meet this mission, VA operates within a complex, multi-vendor IT environment. IO requires comprehensive operational and engineering support across multiple disciplines, including Identity, Credential, and Access Management (ICAM), infrastructure vulnerability management, network and application security, certificate management, application virtualization, database administration, operations and control, Consolidated Mail Outpatient Pharmacy (CMOP), and web and middleware operations. These services are critical to maintaining high availability, security compliance, and performance for VA's enterprise systems and applications.

VA's ICAM program is a cornerstone of its Zero Trust cybersecurity strategy, ensuring that only authorized individuals have access to VA resources. This includes managing enterprise identity services, Single Sign-On (SSO), Identity Governance and Administration (IGA), Privileged Access Management (PAM), and the Master Person Index (MPI). The modernization of these services is essential to reducing technical debt, improving interoperability, and enabling secure digital experiences for Veterans and staff. The contractor will support ICAM transformation through agile delivery, risk assessments, engineering, and change management, while ensuring compliance with federal mandates such as Office of Management and Budget (OMB) M-19-17, National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-63-3, and Executive Order 14028.

In addition to ICAM, IO oversees cybersecurity operations and vulnerability management for over 130 system boundaries and 2 million endpoints. This includes continuous monitoring, remediation of Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEVs), and compliance with directives such as OMB 21-31 and CISA Binding Operational Directives. IO requires technical expertise to strengthen VA's cybersecurity posture through proactive risk identification, remediation, and reporting. IO also manages business continuity and disaster recovery planning for approximately 110 mission-critical systems, ensuring operational resilience during continuity events. This includes developing and testing contingency plans, managing alternate processing sites, and supporting crisis management activities.

Additional areas of responsibility include:

- Network Security Services (NSS): Delivering real-time visibility, attack surface reduction, and compliance enforcement across hybrid environments.

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- Database Administration and Operations: Maintaining Oracle and Structured Query Language (SQL) Server databases, supporting migrations to cloud platforms, and ensuring security and compliance.
- Web Infrastructure and Middleware Support: Sustaining enterprise web environments and middleware platforms, proactive monitoring, and secure configuration management.
- Certificate Management/Public Key Infrastructure (PKI): Supporting over 18.9 billion annual transactions with robust certificate lifecycle management and validation services.

Through these efforts, IO aims to modernize VA's IT infrastructure, enhance cybersecurity, and deliver high-performing, user-centric services that enable VA to meet its mission objectives. The contractor's role is pivotal in achieving these goals by providing innovative solutions, operational excellence, and measurable outcomes under a performance-based contract structure.

2.0 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

In the performance of the tasks associated with this Performance Work Statement, the Contractor shall comply with Applicable Documents cited in the MATOC PWS Section 2.0.

3.0 SCOPE OF WORK

The Contractor shall support the following functional areas in performance of this task order.

Identity, Credential and Access Management (ICAM) Services:
Objective: Deliver, operate, and modernize VA's ICAM services portfolio, ensuring high availability, security compliance, and agile delivery of identity and access capabilities.
Scope & Responsibilities: Provide full lifecycle support for ICAM systems including identity governance, single sign-on, multi-factor authentication, and privileged access management. Responsibilities include system operations, integration of new applications, risk assessments, Zero Trust implementation, roadmap development, policy support, and digital identity risk assessments. Support engineering for onboarding, lifecycle management, troubleshooting, adoption/change management, and training. Ensure compliance with NIST SP 800-63 and VA security standards.
Expected Outcome: Maintain a secure, resilient, and modern identity and access management environment that supports VA enterprise operations.

Infrastructure Vulnerability Management:
Objective: Enhance VA's cybersecurity posture through comprehensive vulnerability management and continuous monitoring across all supported systems and platforms.
Scope & Responsibilities: Identify vulnerabilities using approved scanning tools, analyze results, create and manage POA&Ms, and track remediation activities. Provide guidance for vulnerability mitigation, maintain dashboards and reports, and ensure compliance with federal and VA cybersecurity requirements. Perform posture

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evaluations, KEV remediation, continuous monitoring, customer engagement, metrics reporting, and vulnerability management services.
Expected Outcome: Reduce risk exposure and maintain continuous compliance through proactive vulnerability identification and remediation.

Certificate Management/Public Key Infrastructure (PKI):
Objective: Maintain and optimize VA's PKI system to support secure digital transactions and identity validation.
Scope & Responsibilities: Operate and maintain PKI environment including certificate authorities, validation authorities, Online Certificate Status Protocol (OCSP) responders, and CDPs. Manage certificate issuance and lifecycle, monitor performance, and deliver compliance reporting. Provide technical support for PKI integrations and ensure high availability of PKI services.
Expected Outcome: Ensure secure and reliable PKI operations that enable trusted digital transactions across VA systems.

Web Infrastructure and Administration:
Objective: Sustain and optimize VA's enterprise web infrastructure to ensure uptime and secure operations.
Scope & Responsibilities: Provide administration and technical support for web servers, databases, and middleware components. Manage incident response, change management, performance monitoring, and content promotions. Ensure compliance with VA security baselines and maintain documentation for all configurations and processes.
Expected Outcome: Maintain a secure, stable, and scalable web environment that supports VA mission-critical applications and services.

Middleware
Objective: Maintain and optimize VA's middleware and file transfer infrastructure to ensure secure, reliable, and high-performing operations that support mission-critical applications and data exchange across VA systems.
Scope & Responsibilities: Provide comprehensive middleware and file transfer administration services to ensure secure, reliable, and high-performing operations. Sustain critical application environments, support secure data exchange, maintain compliance with VA security standards, and enable continuous availability of systems that underpin mission-critical services. Deliver proactive monitoring, incident response, and lifecycle management to optimize performance, minimize downtime, and support VA's evolving technology needs.
Expected Outcome: Deliver secure, stable, and compliant middleware and file transfer operations that maintain uptime, support VA's enterprise applications, and enable uninterrupted data exchange across VA systems.

Application Virtualization:
Objective: Support VA's application virtualization environment, ensuring efficient delivery and management of virtualized applications.

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Scope & Responsibilities: Maintain virtualization platforms, perform upgrades, troubleshoot issues, and optimize performance. Ensure compliance with VA security standards and provide documentation and reporting on virtualization operations.
Expected Outcome: Deliver a reliable and secure application virtualization solution that enhances user experience and operational efficiency.

Printer Security Management:
Objective: Manage and secure VA's enterprise printing environment to prevent unauthorized access and protect sensitive information.
Scope & Responsibilities: Implement printer security configurations, monitor compliance, manage firmware updates, and respond to security incidents. Maintain inventory records, provide reporting, and ensure adherence to VA security policies.
Expected Outcome: Maintain a secure and compliant printing infrastructure that mitigates risks and supports VA operations.

Database Administration:
Objective: Provide database administration and operational support for VA's enterprise databases.
Scope & Responsibilities: Perform installations, upgrades, backups, and recovery operations. Monitor performance and tune databases for optimal efficiency. Ensure compliance with VA security standards, maintain documentation, and provide incident response for database-related issues.
Expected Outcome: Ensure secure, reliable, and high-performing database environments that support VA applications and services.

Operations Control & Consolidated Mail Outpatient Pharmacy:
Objective: Support VA's certified mail order pharmacy operations, ensuring timely and accurate processing of prescriptions and related services.
Scope & Responsibilities: Maintain production systems, monitor performance, troubleshoot issues, and implement security and compliance measures. Provide technical support, maintain documentation, and deliver reporting on operational status and performance.
Expected Outcome: Ensure reliable, secure, and efficient mail order pharmacy operations that meet VA's healthcare delivery requirements.

4.0 PERFORMANCE DETAILS

4.1 PERFORMANCE PERIOD

The PoP shall 12 months from date of award, with four 12-month option period(s) and Optional Tasks that have the following period of performances:

5.1.1.1 Active Director Product Delivery and Operations – Executed monthly, not to exceed the PoP
5.1.7 Identify Governance and Administration Modernization – Executed monthly, not to exceed the PoP
5.1.8 Active Directory Modernization Planning – Six months from date of exercise

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7.0 Surge Support – Within 10 business days from date of exercise.

The overall Period of Performance shall not exceed 60 months.

The Contractor shall ensure resource availability during VA business hours (8:00am Eastern Time through 4:30PM Pacific Time), unless otherwise specified.

4.2 PLACE OF PERFORMANCE

Tasks under this PWS shall be performed in VA facilities located in ***<place(s) of performance***>. Work may be performed at remote locations with prior concurrence from the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR).

Tasks under this PWS shall be performed at Contractor facilities. The Contractor shall identify the Contractor's place of performance in their proposal submission***.***

4.3 TRAVEL

The Government anticipates travel under this effort to perform the tasks associated with the effort, as well as to attend program-related meetings or conferences throughout the PoP. Include all estimated travel costs in your firm-fixed price line items. These costs will not be directly reimbursed by the Government.

The total estimated number of trips in support of the program related meetings for this effort is ***<please enter number of trips>***. Anticipated locations include the following, estimated at ***<please enter duration of trips>*** days in duration:

1. <List location(s)>

Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR) and requires advanced concurrence by the Task Order COR. Contractor travel within the local commuting area will not be reimbursed.

5.0 SPECIFIC TASKS AND DELIVERABLES

The Application Services Domain delivers secure, high-performing, and compliant enterprise applications that power VA's mission-critical systems. The Contractor shall support the Application Services domain in accordance with the following functional areas as defined in the parent contract PWS:

- Identity, Credential, and Access Management
- Infrastructure Vulnerability Management
- Certificate Management/Public Key Infrastructure
- Web Infrastructure and Administration
- Middleware
- Application Virtualization
- Printer Security Management
- Database Administration
- Operations Control
- Task Order Program Management

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The Contractor shall support these areas in accordance with the specific tasks described below.

5.1 IDENTITY, CREDENTIAL AND ACCESS MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall sustain, enhance, and operate the set of products that make up its Identity, Credential, and Access Management (ICAM) Services portfolio, while also ensuring the timely and reliable integration of those products with applications across the VA. The ICAM Services portfolio spans legacy and modern systems inclusive of Software-as-a-Service (SaaS), Commercial Off-the-Shelf (COTS) software and custom-developed software hosted in the VA Cloud.

VA requires continuous modernization efforts to build a cohesive ICAM platform leveraging modern tools, services, and processes to improve the VA's cybersecurity posture, usability, and ease of access for VA systems, and improve cost efficiency and reduce technical debt. The Contractor shall maintain and operate both the legacy and modern systems and ensure the resilience of legacy ICAM products during the transition to modern solutions. Modernization tasks shall include, but are not limited to, transitioning legacy systems to cloud-based platforms, integrating new capabilities, and supporting surge operations.

The ICAM portfolio includes the following products:

- Internal Single Sign On (SSO) – Allows internal users, i.e. VA workforce, to authenticate to VA systems with their PIV cards or alternative Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) credential.
  - Currently implemented with Microsoft Entra ID, including tooling for configuration-as-code capabilities and integrations with VA identity services and legacy authentication flows. There is also limited us of legacy authentication services such as Active Directory Federation Services (ADFS) by applications that still need to be migrated to Entra ID.
  - Currently supporting approximately 600k users and over 500m authentications per month, integrated with over 1,000 VA systems.
- External SSO – Allows external users, e.g. Veterans, to authenticate to VA systems with MFA and optionally identity verification.
  - Currently implemented with Okta, including tooling for configuration-as-code capabilities and integration with 3rd-party Credential Service Providers, VA identity services, and legacy authentication flows.
  - Currently supporting 3m users and approximately 10m authentications per month, integrated with over 200 VA systems.
- Identity Governance and Administration (IGA) – Facilitates identity lifecycle management and application access management, including access request and reviews.
  - Currently implemented through both a legacy, custom-developed solution (Account Provisioning and Deprovisioning Systems, or APDS) as well as a modern, FedRAMP-authorized SaaS solution (Saviynt), which is in the process of being fully implemented as the modernized solution.

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  - Currently supporting onboarding 60% of all new users and managing access for approximately 50 different VA systems through APDS, will eventually be integrated with hundreds of VA systems.
- Enterprise Identity Datastore, i.e. VA Master Person Index (MPI) – Serves as the authoritative enterprise source for VA known identities and their traits/attributes.
  - Correlate identity data from various sources including Department of Defense (DoD) and 3rd-party Cloud Service Providers, leveraging probabilistic matching through IBM Master Data Management for identity resolution and retrieval
  - Implemented as a combination of COTS products and custom-built software and tooling.
  - Currently managing over 85m unique identities, serving 900m transactions per month, integrated with over 200 applications.
- Enterprise Workforce Directory – Serves as the authoritative data source for VA workforce identities, devices, and policies.
  - Currently implemented through an on-prem/VA Enterprise Cloud-hosted Active Directory (AD) environment and Microsoft Entra ID, with the latter as the future cloud-based solution. Also includes custom scripts and tooling to facilitate operational support for both regular and privileged users.
  - Includes services such as Server Security Structures, Trust Relationships, Logon Authentication, Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP), Domain Name Service (DNS), Browsers, Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) in an AD environment, Domain Structures, and Domain Database Synchronization.
  - Currently managing over 700k identities and 3.3m total objects across 34 domains in the on-premises environment, synced to Entra ID in both the Azure Commercial and Microsoft Azure for Government clouds.
- Privileged Access Management (PAM) – Provides password vaulting and other Privileged Access Management capabilities to allow the VA to manage over 15,000 privileged users and over 75,000 non-individually identifiable accounts.
  - Currently implemented through CyberArk hosted across three VA data centers with approximately 150 servers, including password vault, Application Programming Interface (API) secrets management and vaulting, and threat analytics features. This suite provides centralized management of non-individually identifiable accounts and privileged accounts.
- Veteran Health Identification Card (VHIC) – Used to issue health identification cards for use at VA medical facilities to streamline the appointment check-in process. VHIC also serves as the system of record for Veteran photographs.
  - Currently implemented as a custom-developed software solution.

All ICAM products and services will be operated following modern DevOps best practices and tools, such as configuration-as-code, and Agile delivery methods, meeting minimum availability targets to ensure the resilience of dependent VA systems. The Contractor shall provide Tier 3 operational support to ICAM services, with a focus on responsiveness and user satisfaction. The Contractor must ensure compliance with federal mandates, such as OMB M-19-17 and NIST SP 800-63-3, while also supporting ICAM program delivery, a cohesive customer experience for VA product and application

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teams integrating with ICAM services, digital identity risk assessments, policy development, and change management.

Technologies currently utilized by the ICAM portfolio include the following:

1. DataPower XML Security Gateway
2. F5 BIG-IP DNS
3. Java SE
4. Microsoft Internet Information Services (IIS)
5. Microsoft Windows Server
6. Microsoft PowerShell
7. Red Hat Enterprise Linux
8. Splunk Enterprise
9. Splunk Universal Forwarder
10. AppDynamics (AppD)
11. Ansible
12. Oracle Enterprise Manager
13. Java JRE
14. WebLogic Serve
15. Oracle Database
16. JasperReports Library
17. InfoSphere Master Data Management (MDM)
18. Websphere Application Server (WAS)
19. Apache Struts
20. Hibernate Object Relational Mapping (ORM)
21. Jagacy 3270
22. Web Access Manager Agent (formerly CA SSO Web Agent)
23. CA Directory/ Symantec Directory
24. Apache Tomcat
25. Bootstrap
26. Spring Framework
27. Apache HTTP Server
28. IBM Security Directory Server
29. IBM DB2
30. iText Core
31. JavaScript
32. J2EE, including Enterprise JavaBeans (EJB), Java Servlets, Java Server Pages (JSP), Struts
33. HyperText Markup Language (HTML) and Cascading Style Sheets
34. Relational databases and Structured Query Language (SQL)
35. Extensible Markup Language (XML) Schemas & Document Type Definition (DTD)
36. Junit
37. DataPower XI50/xI52
38. DataPower XML Security Gateway [IBM DataPower]
39. DB2 [IBM DB2 Universal Database Enterprise Server Edition]
40. IBM HTTP Server
41. Java DB [Apache Derby]

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42. WildFly
43. Microsoft Azure, including Microsoft Entra ID
44. Amazon Web Services (AWS)
45. Okta Customer Identity Solution
46. Saviynt Identity Cloud
47. Microsoft Active Directory
48. CyberArk (Digital Vault, Privileged Vault Web Access, Privileged Threat Analytics, Central Policy Manager, Privileged Session Manager, Privileged Session Manager SSH, Application Access Manager, Conjur)

5.1.1 ICAM SERVICES AGILE PRODUCT DELIVERY AND OPERATIONS

The Contractor shall maintain and operate all ICAM products and services listed above following Agile delivery practices, meeting availability targets and addressing security issues in a timely manner, maintaining any VA-managed infrastructure following industry-standard best practices, and delivering new features and other improvements to meet product requirements. The ICAM product Enterprise Identity Datastore is current operated by Government personnel, the Contractor shall be required to provide these services should Optional Task under section 5.2.1.1 be exercised. The Contractor shall perform the following:

1. Product Management
   - Produce and continuously enhance product and service roadmaps (ICAM Product Roadmaps) for each product and service in ICAM that align with business priorities and user needs. Roadmaps shall include key delivery milestones and objectives for each product and be updated quarterly.
   - Develop and maintain a prioritized ICAM Product Backlog for each product containing user stories and epics that reflect the current and future needs of the organization and its users. The backlogs shall be updated and re-prioritized for every sprint.
   - Facilitate iterative development sprints following modern agile processes and ceremonies, ensuring continuous improvement and alignment with goals. Each sprint for each product shall specify goals and progress on stories and shall be tracked in Jira (Sprint Goals and Jira Tracking).
   - Ensure 90% completion of user stories and epics in VA's Jira instance within each sprint as tracked against Sprint Goals.
   - Develop and maintain ICAM Product Risk Registers tracking delivery risks for every sprint.
2. Human-Centered Design
   - Develop user-centric solutions using personas, customer journeys, user research and usability testing.
   - Maintain consistent look, feel, and digital accessibility in line with the VA Design System and VA Content Style Guide (https://design.va.gov/).
   - Develop and conduct User Acceptance Testing (UAT) for completed user stories and system integrations, supporting Agile methodologies.
3. Development and Integration

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- Deliver seamless software deployment processes across all environments including development, staging, and production, achieving continuous integration and continuous development (CI/CD) when possible to ensure timely updates, high-quality releases, and reduced downtime.
- Ensure all new features and enhancements are comprehensively tested using automated frameworks, aligning with Test-Driven Development practices.
- Ensure all production changes follow the OIT Change Control process and track all changes in a Change Log. Ensure 98% of monthly changes are completed successfully without requiring rollback.
- Achieve and maintain successful integrations of approximately 70 new applications annually with ICAM services, with a 5% anticipated annual growth rate. Examples of integrations include the following:
  - Deploying a new VA application integration with Internal SSO to allow VA staff to authenticate.
  - Updating the specific identity attributes a VA application receives in the authentication response from External SSO.
  - Configuring a VA application to be able to query VA MPI and retrieve identity information about VA persons of interest.
  - Integrating a new VA application with the IGA product to allow users to submit access requests and conduct periodic access reviews.
- Ensure that all configuration and sensitive data is stored in encrypted credential management systems with no inclusion in source code.
- Manage configuration changes for commercial tools that are part of ICAM products using configuration-as-code tools such as Terraform instead of manually through the user interface, to the extent that it is technically feasible.

4. System Availability and Reliability
   - Achieve and maintain 99.99% availability for the production environment of Internal SSO, External SSO, and the Enterprise Identity Datastore.
   - Achieve and maintain 99.9% availability for the production environment of all other ICAM products and services.
   - Maintain 99% availability of non-production environments during 8 am – 8 pm Eastern Standard Time (EST), Monday through Friday.
   - Provide Monthly Availability Report for all ICAM products and their different environments that tracks system availability against established Service Level Agreements (SLA).
5. Incident Response and Recovery
   - Provide Incident Response and Disaster Recovery (DR) as per Authority To Operate (ATO) guidelines for each product.
   - Conduct triage, troubleshooting, and resolution activities for incidents adhering to VA's Major Incident Management process.
   - Provide after-hours emergency support from 8 pm – 8 am ET Monday through Friday and 24-hour during weekends for all products and services.
   - Provide Incident Review / After Action Reports within 2 hours of incident resolution and provide a detailed Root Cause Analysis within 24 hours.

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- Follow VA policies and procedures as identified in VA Directive 6500, Handbook 6500, and all ATO documentation for reporting and responding to critical security incidents.
- Maintain technical and administrative documentation for all systems and products, including but not limited to ATO and other compliance documentation, DR plans, technical architecture, operational processes and procedures, technical decisions, project status reports.
- Perform annual DR test for each ICAM product or service to validate the accuracy of DR plans and the team's readiness to execute it.

6. Infrastructure Management
   - Install, configure, and manage ICAM portfolio server systems using automated tools and scripting languages such as PowerShell and Terraform.
   - Administer updates, patches, and upgrades to VA-managed infrastructure, minimizing interruptions by scheduling during after-hours/weekends.
   - Operate and manage all associated infrastructure, including virtual networking tools and services, application hosting, and databases in compliance with the VA's Technical Reference Model (TRM) and Risk Management Framework (RMF).
   - Implement and maintain comprehensive platform support automation, monitoring, logging, and alerting to ensure the resiliency of ICAM products.
7. Operational Support and Ticket Management
   - Provide Tier 3 operational support, resolving 95% of high- and critical-priority tickets and 90% of all other tickets within SLA timeframes. Total ticket volume across all included products is approximately 65k-85k tickets annually.
   - Maintain a ticket backlog below 200 tickets in 90% of months and below 300 tickets consistently.
   - Track and report operational metrics such as ticket throughput, ticket backlog, response, and resolution times. Provide a Monthly Ticket Report with those metrics broken out by ICAM product.
   - Provide regular notifications to impacted users during ticket resolution and maintain updated knowledge documentation.
   - Manage user access to ICAM products in alignment with VA security policies and associated ATOs.
   - Track and ensure compliance with Ticket SLAs as identified below:
     - Normal Priority: First response within 1 business day and resolution within 7 business days.
     - High Priority: First response within 30 minutes and resolution within 4 hours.
     - Critical Priority: First response within 15 minutes and resolution within 1 hour.
   - Examples of representative support tickets include:
     - A VA employee has an issue authenticating via the Internal SSO product.
     - A VA employee is encountering an error when submitting an access request.
     - A Veteran's identity attributes in VA MPI are incorrect and need to be updated to the correct values.
     - A PAM user encounters an error accessing a resource with their privileged credential.
8. Data Management

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- Ensure the integrity of all data in ICAM services, e.g. MPI and IGA, and address any requests for bulk validation or cleanup of invalid entries.
- Develop scripts and automated tools for routine data integrations and data validation and cleanup requests, including any documentation as needed.
- Ensure accurate reconciliation of identities across all ICAM services.
- Generate reports on user roles and entitlements for VA systems integrated with the IGA product and associated services.

9. Product-Specific Requirements
   - Internal SSO & External SSO
     - 90% or more of all configuration changes in production shall be implemented using configuration-as-code tools, instead of manually through SaaS UIs.
   - PAM
     - New accounts shall be onboarded within 6 business hours of request submission.
     - 95% or more of accounts shall be maintained in a compliant status.
     - Provide a monthly PAM Account report that includes onboarding times for each new account added and a list of accounts that are non-compliant.

Deliverables
ICAM Product Roadmaps
Monthly Availability Report
Monthly Ticket Report

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
A resilient, agile ICAM product portfolio environment with high availability and proactive incident management	Availability of Internal SSO, External SSO, and Enterprise Identity Datastore production environments	99.99% uptime	Monthly Availability Report, Incident Review and After-Action Reports, Root Cause Analyses
A resilient, agile ICAM product portfolio environment with high availability and proactive incident management	Availability of IGA, PAM, and VHIC production environments	99.9% uptime	Monthly Availability Report, Incident Review and After-Action Reports, Root Cause Analyses
High and critical priority resolved.	Resolution of high and critical priority tickets within timeframes 95% of the time.	95%	Monthly Ticket Report

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Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Normal priority tickets resolved.	Resolution of normal priority tickets within seven days.	90%	Monthly Ticket Report
Maintain ticket backlog within required parameters.	Ticket backlog	<200 for 90% of months, <300 100% of the time.	Monthly Ticket Report
Production changes follow the OIT Change Control process and track all changes in a Change Log.	Monthly change success rate	98% success rate	Change Logs
Completion of user stories and epics in VA's Jira instance within each sprint as tracked against Sprint Goals.	Sprint goal completion rate	90% of planned work completed	Sprint Goals and Jira Tracking

5.1.1.1 ACTIVE DIRECTORY PRODUCT DELIVERY AND OPERATIONS (OPTIONAL TASK)

The Contractor shall provide product delivery and operational support to the VA's Enterprise Workforce Directory, as defined in Section 5.1 to include both the legacy Active Directory environment deployed to the VA Enterprise Cloud, as well as Microsoft Entra ID. The Enterprise Workforce Directory operational support generally handles approximately 30k-40k support tickets annually. The Contractor shall:

1. Meet an availability target of 99.9% for all production environments included in the Enterprise Workforce Directory product.
2. Follow all requirements and performance metrics defined in PWS Section 5.1.1. ICAM Services and Agile Product Delivery and Operations to meet the outcomes identified.

Deliverables

Enterprise Workforce Directory Product Roadmap
Enterprise Workforce Directory Monthly Availability Report
Enterprise Workforce Directory Monthly Ticket Report

5.1.2 ICAM ENTERPRISE PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall provide enterprise program management efforts to coordinate and manage VA's ICAM overarching delivery and modernization efforts across all ICAM

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products, ensuring alignment with broader organizational goals and regulatory requirements. The Contractor shall:

- Develop and manage ICAM program-wide Key Performance Indicators (KPIs). This includes setting baselines, creating benchmarks, and developing outcome-based measurements to monitor and adjust ICAM efforts, ensuring alignment with enterprise OKRs. KPIs shall be continuously updated and maintained as ICAM and enterprise OKRs change.
- Create and maintain an ICAM program-wide Risk Register on a monthly basis to identify, track, and manage risks across all ICAM products and the overall program, aligned with the product-specific Risk Registers.
- Develop and maintain a comprehensive enterprise ICAM Program Roadmap driving cohesive and strategic ICAM implementation and aligned with the roadmaps for each individual ICAM product and enterprise strategic objectives.

Deliverable
ICAM Program Roadmap

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Establish and maintain a comprehensive ICAM program-wide KPI framework that ensures continuous alignment with enterprise OKRs	ICAM KPIs documented, aligned with enterprise OKRs, and reviewed quarterly	100%	ICAM Program-Wide KPIs

5.1.3 ICAM CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE AND CHANGE MANAGEMENT

The Contractor's customer experience support shall deliver seamless, positive experience throughout the ICAM product delivery process, ultimately enhancing user satisfaction and ensuring the products meet customer expectations effectively.

The Contractor shall:

1. **ICAM Customer Relationship Management and Knowledge Base:**
   - Develop and update repository of key contacts and stakeholders of all application teams leveraging ICAM services, currently approximately 1,000 teams (ICAM Customer Repository).
   - Actively engage customers through various channels to gather feedback and address issues. Maintain open communication lines to build trust and ensure transparency throughout the product delivery process.
   - Develop and maintain a central Knowledge Base with Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) and troubleshooting guides.
2. **ICAM Transformation Communications:**

DRAFT

- Develop and execute communication strategies for effective, accurate and timely ICAM updates using SharePoint, Teams FAQs, newsletters, etc.
- Respond to ad-hoc information requests and provide enterprise-wide access to ICAM policies and updates.
- Support strategic communications for release management, including change management and training. Include scripts, templates, and emails to address service requests efficiently.
- Report on communications metrics such as open rate, click rate, and page views (ICAM Communications Report) and maintain SharePoint and Teams sites, managing artifacts and user privileges.
- Develop and execute a customer satisfaction survey instrument, governance, and rollout plan. Initiate the rollout of customer satisfaction survey and continuously administer on a bi-monthly basis. Deliver survey insights and recommendations to support measurable and continuous improvements in ICAM services.

3. ICAM Guidance and Training:

- Deliver monthly training events and packages for ICAM users, coordinating with technical teams and stakeholders. On average, training events shall include 25-50 participants, and up to 5 trainings per month will be held.
- Develop role-specific training materials for ICAM products and services, including user guides and training modules.
- Offer online training sessions and produce training reports (ICAM Training Report) listing attendees and participation times for all trainings held.
- Create job aids, user guides, and Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) to support ICAM service implementation.

The Contractor shall support change management for ensuring the success of ICAM modernization, facilitating positive customer experiences while mitigating potential negative impacts. The Contractor shall perform the following migration and sunset activities:

- Plan and manage the transition from legacy to modernized ICAM services from start to finish, in collaboration with the associated product delivery teams.
- Develop decommissioning plans and provide implementation steps from planning to realization.
- Adjust existing business processes and develop release management plans, maintaining historical logs for traceability.
- Facilitate stakeholder engagement through working groups, leadership briefs, and stakeholder updates.

Deliverables

Quarterly ICAM Communications Report
Quarterly ICAM Training Report

DRAFT

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Effective and clear dissemination of information, and improved clarity and understanding of ICAM communications and services	Measurable and continuous improvements of ICAM customer experience.	Insights and recommendations every other month.	Customer satisfaction survey results, survey insights and recommendations

5.1.4 ICAM INNOVATION SUPPORT

The Contractor shall support strategic planning for ICAM modernization and program activities through discovery, research, use-case development, and hosting Innovation Lab sessions to share opportunities and technological advances with VA leadership. The Contractor shall:

- Conduct thorough studies and analyses to identify innovative ICAM opportunities and provide a quarterly ICAM Innovations Report outlining those opportunities.
- Identify and develop use-cases for cutting-edge technologies, such as mobile-centric biometric authentication, to enhance trust, accountability, and end-user satisfaction.
- Organize and conduct innovation lab sessions (minimum one annually) to foster collaboration between ICAM subject matter experts and VA leadership. Facilitate discussions that enable informed decision-making on the integration of new tools, technologies, and processes in line with VA's ICAM vision and provide a written executive read-out following the event.

Deliverables

ICAM Innovations quarterly report
Annual ICAM Innovation Lab read-out

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Ensure VA leadership informed on technology opportunities to support strategic planning for ICAM modernization	Quarterly innovation updates	At least one quarterly innovation/opportunity presented that aligns to VAs strategic goals	ICAM Innovations Report

5.1.5 DIGITAL IDENTITY RISK MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall conduct and maintain processes to apply digital identity risk management as required by OMB Memorandum M-19-17, "Enabling Mission Delivery

DRAFT

through Improved Identity, Credential, and Access Management (ICAM)", and National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication 800-63-3 Digital Identity Guidelines. The Contractor shall:

1. Maintain and update processes for Digital Identity Risk Assessments (DIRA) processes and conduct Digital Identity Risk Assessments for VA applications ensuring compliance with OMB 19-17 and NIST 800-63-3.
2. Conduct technical reviews of VA applications (60-70 annually) and evaluate which processes and technologies will be employed to meet each assurance level and document these decisions in a "Digital Identity Acceptance (DIA) Statement" to provide VA with a comprehensive assessment of their applications.
3. Deliver quality and timely technical reviews, effective guidance for stakeholders with clear action items, and feedback loops. Provide quarterly DIRA Assessment Report with assessments completed and response times.
4. Develop and provide program recommendations ensuring VA processes are compliant with NIST 800-63-3, including selection of assurance levels commensurate with the risk to VA's digital service offerings.

Deliverable
Quarterly DIRA Assessment Report

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Develop and Execute Digital Identity Risk Assessment process	DIRA Processes Documented	100% Compliance	Digital Identity Acceptance (DIA) Statement

5.1.6 IDENTITY, SECURITY, AND DATA INTEGRATION RISK, REMEDIATION, COMPLIANCE, AND POLICY SUPPORT

The Contractor shall help ensure ICAM products and services align and comply with Federal mandates, guidelines, and best practices. They shall also ensure that related VA policy is in compliance with Office of Inspector General (OIG) recommendations and aligns with federal requirements and guidance, including the FICAM Roadmap and Implementation Guidance, OMB M-19-17, "Enabling Mission Delivery Through Improved Identity, Credential, and Access Management (ICAM)," NIST SP 800-63-3, Executive Order 14028, OMB M-22- 09, "Moving the U.S. Government Toward Zero Trust Cybersecurity Principles," and NIST SP 800-207.

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop briefings, create action plans, and support meetings to address Notice of Findings (NFR) and material weakness remediation activities identified by Office of the Inspector General (OIG) and FISMA findings on access reviews, access termination, two factor authentication, and other ICAM areas
2. Support ICAM audit reporting requirements, such as CIO reporting, CAP reporting, NFR reporting, ICAM self-assessments, and OMB reporting.

DRAFT

3. Maintain repository of Federal policy guidance and documentation of standards upon their release, such as NIST 800-63-3.
4. Develop, update, and maintain VA ICAM Policy 6510 Directive and Handbook, including coordinating review processes for policy updates leveraging VA's VIEWS process, ensuring all comments are incorporated as VA ICAM comments into a policy package, ensuring proper documentation of comments and changes, briefing note(s), and concurrence sheet(s), and ensuring published policies are posted to the appropriate sources, including ICAM websites, VA Publication sites, SharePoint sites, and Teams channels.
5. Participate in federal and VA working groups, such as the ICAM Steering Committee (ICAMSC), Credential Provider Working Group (CPWG), Federal Public Key Infrastructure (FPKI) forums, joint DoD/VA ICAM working groups, and other VA-specific groups, and report back to VA ICAM stakeholders on meaningful results of meetings and any required actions.
6. Provide support with reviews and translation of federal guidelines, including those from the White House, Office of Management and Budget (OMB), Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA), National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), peer federal agencies, commercial sector best practices, and industry experts.

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Ensure reporting requirements and action plans capture and track all OIG findings.	All OIG findings tracked	100%	OIG action plans and audit reporting
Maintain VA ICAM Policy 6510 Directive and Handbook	VA ICAM Policy 6510 Directive and Handbook reviewed annually for any required updates	100%	VA Publication sites

5.1.7 IDENTITY GOVERNANCE AND ADMINISTRATION (IGA) MODERNIZATION (OPTIONAL TASK)

The Contractor shall support VAs implementation of an enterprise solution based on the Saviynt Enterprise Identity Cloud SaaS tool that will provide IGA capabilities to all estimated 1100 VA applications. This shall require integrating and connecting Saviynt to the many systems required for key features of the IGA System such as access reviews, access requests, identity lifecycle management (provisioning and deprovisioning), and automated workflows. The Contractor shall develop and deploy all required capabilities within the Saviynt SaaS tool and facilitate a smooth transition to sustainment and operations of new capabilities in the Saviynt-based IGA platform, following Agile best practices and other requirements as stated in PWS Section 5.2.1. ICAM Services and

DRAFT

Agile Product Delivery and Operations. These transitions are broken out into 2 categories:

1. **Legacy APDS Transition –** The Contractor will be responsible for fully implementing all required capabilities within Saviynt to replace APDS and migrate all integrations and existing identity management capabilities from APDS to Saviynt so that APDS can be decommissioned. It is estimated that the modernization effort to fully transition APDS to the Saviynt-based IGA platform will require 12 months. Estimated breakdown of Contractor configuration effort and application summary:

Integration Type	Configuration Effort	APDS Integration Breakdown
Standard	No Code	3
Medium	Low Code	14
Complex	Custom	29

2. **Integration of Other Existing Systems and Applications -** The Contractor will be responsible for integrating and connecting over 1100 applications that do not currently leverage APDS. It is estimated that the modernization effort to fully transition APDS to the Saviynt-based IGA platform will require 24 months. Estimated breakdown of configuration and application summary:

Integration Type	Configuration Effort	APDS Integration Breakdown
Standard	No Code	1034
Medium	Low Code	68
Complex	Custom	30

The following documentation will be available as part of the transition to the Contractor under this scope of work.

- Product documentation including product outlines/briefings, OKRs, roadmaps and active epics/stories, stakeholder landscape maps, decision records, and analytics.
- Developer documentation including READMEs, set-up instructions, diagrams, relevant databases and services.
- Design documentation including prototypes, user research reports, design decisions for products in production, early designs for incomplete products, content strategy, and records of interactions with the collaboration cycle.
- Access to accounts for third-party products such as tooling or SaaS products that will be taken over by the new team.

The Contractor shall be responsible for:

- Produce and continuously enhancing the IGA Modernization Product Roadmap aligning with business priorities and user needs. The IGA Modernization Product Roadmap shall include key delivery milestones and objectives and be updated quarterly.

DRAFT

- Develop and maintain a prioritized IGA Modernization Product Backlog containing user stories and epics that reflect the current and future needs of the organization and users. The backlogs shall be updated and reprioritized for every sprint.
- Facilitate iterative development sprints following modern agile processes and ceremonies, ensuring continuous improvement and alignment with goals. Each sprint for each product shall specify goals and progress on stories and shall be tracked in Jira (Sprint Goals and Jira Tracking).
- Ensure 90% completion of user stories and epics in VA's Jira instance within each sprint as tracked against Sprint Goals.
- Develop and maintain an IGA Modernization Product Risk Register tracking delivery risks for every sprint.

Deliverable
IGA Modernization Product Roadmap

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Completion of user stories and epics in VA's Jira instance within each sprint as tracked against Sprint Goals.	Sprint goal completion rate	90% of planned work completed	Sprint Goals and Jira Tracking

5.1.8 ACTIVE DIRECTORY MODERNIZATION PLANNING (OPTIONAL TASK)

VA's Enterprise Workforce Directory is currently in a hybrid state, with a substantial on-premises Active Directory implementation spanning 34 domains, over 23,000 Organizational Units, nearly 8,000 Group Policy Objects, nearly 700 domain controllers, and almost 700k identities. In addition, the VA is leveraging Microsoft Entra ID as the future workforce Identity platform for both Single Sign-On and Enterprise Directory capabilities. The VA would like to ultimately transition to nearly all Enterprise Directory capabilities being served by Entra ID, and requires technical strategy and delivery support to migrate from legacy Active Directory to Entra ID.

Upon execution of this optional task, the Contractor shall:

- Deliver a detailed modernization roadmap with specific timeframes for key milestones and a target for fully migrating from Active Directory to Entra ID as the primary Enterprise Workforce Directory, not longer than three (3) years from the start of the roadmap.
- Deliver a target state architecture defining what the technical architecture for the Enterprise Workforce Directory will be in the future state, identifying any required technologies required beyond Microsoft Entra ID.

Deliverables:

- Active Directory Modernization Roadmap

DRAFT

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
The VA has a comprehensive and executable plan for modernizing Active Directory	Modernization roadmap delivery	100%	Active Directory Modernization Product Roadmap

5.2 INFRASTRUCTURE VULNERABILITY MANAGEMENT

VA requires comprehensive cybersecurity and infrastructure operations support across multiple domains, RMF authorization, vulnerability management, Privileged Access Management (PAM), business continuity, and disaster recovery. The Contractor shall manage over 150 ATO packages annually, maintain cybersecurity posture across 130+ system boundaries, and ensure compliance with federal mandates such as Federal Information Systems Management Act (FISMA), NIST, and OMB directives. Services include continuous monitoring, KEV remediation, endpoint protection, cloud security, network visibility, and support for over 2 million endpoints. The Contractor shall also deliver technical documentation, training, and operational support for cybersecurity tools, data centers, and web applications, ensuring high availability, minimal downtime, and measurable performance outcomes.

5.2.1 RISK MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK AND AUTHORIZATION SUPPORT

The Contractor shall perform required duties and prepare artifacts to obtain an ATO for all assigned application systems managed by the Infrastructure Operations Authorization Support (IOAS) team. Additionally, the Contractor shall perform RMF tasks by properly managing and maintaining Plans of Actions and Milestones (POA&Ms) and provide oversight for Assessment and Authorization operations. The Contractor shall provide IO Authorization Support for RMF system as System Stewards. An RMF system steward is responsible for the day-to-day management of an information system's record within a Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) tool.

The Contractor shall:

1. Register the system in the RMF tool, assign user roles, ensure the system record is accurate and up to date and determine the appropriate security categorization for the system.
2. Document and manage security controls, including POA&M items, and ensure they are implemented and maintained.
3. Upload and manage artifacts (documentation, evidence) related to the system and its security controls.
4. Initiate and manage workflows within the RMF tool to facilitate progress through the RMF steps.
5. Participate in the continuous monitoring of the system to ensure it remains compliant and secure.

DRAFT

6. Work and coordinate with other stakeholders, such as system owners, security teams, and authorizing officials, to ensure effective communication and coordination.

The Contractor shall, within the GRC tool, create and review System Security Plans (SSP) and hardware/software inventory lists, assess artifacts and evidence required as implementation details, test results for security control items. The Contractor shall also support risk management as it relates to systems, with an emphasis on security controls and POA&Ms, as detailed in NIST 800-30. VA IO-AS has approximately 150 ATO packages per year, depending on supported application workload. Typically, 5-10 packages may be worked concurrently at any time based on the ATO review schedule and security incidents.

The Contractor shall provide the following cybersecurity support services:

1. Provide the support detailed below to IO-AS to obtain the initial or renew an existing ATO for the application system, platform, or facility supported.
    a. Provide cybersecurity subject matter expertise for the major applications, minor applications, platforms, and facilities ATO packages support.
    b. Provide support and execute actions required for the RMF and Authorization & Assessment (A&A) activities within the VA GRC tool, address the following steps at a minimum:
        - Step 1 – Prepare: Conduct essential activities to prepare the organization to manage security and privacy risks.
        - Step 2 – Categorize: Categorize the system and information processed, stored, and transmitted based on an impact analysis.
        - Step 3 - Select. Select the set of NIST SP 800-53 controls to protect the system based on risk assessment(s).
        - Step 4 – Implement: Implement the controls and document how controls are deployed.
        - Step 5 – Assess: Assess to determine if the controls are in place, operating as intended, and producing the desired results.
        - Step 6 – Authorize: Senior official makes a risk-based decision to authorize the system (to operate).
        - Step 7 – Monitor: Continuously monitor control implementation and risks to the system.
            - Verify information system design complies with NIST standards, as well as VA cybersecurity policies, and VA-approved baseline configurations.
            - Author and coordinate signature on all required security artifact documents.
            - Communicate with system stakeholders for initiation and completion of customer-performed actions, gather and document implementation details, collect evidence of compliance or non-applicability, capture actions to correct non-compliance with POA&Ms, collect hardware and software

DRAFT

equipment inventories, and properly maintain all items within the GRC tool.

2. Support the continuous monitoring processes for each supported application system, platform, or facility.
   a. Track vulnerabilities identified by the security compliance and monitoring tools, open and manage POA&Ms when applicable, document remediation activities when directed, and provide status updates upon request.
   b. Author, review, and update privacy, configuration, contingency planning, business impact, vulnerability management, incident response, and other SOP documents, and perform updates where necessary.
   c. Maintain awareness and knowledge on Information Security related criteria and guidance such as FISMA, NIST Special Pubs, OMB Memorandum, Privacy Act, Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA), applicable VA directives and handbooks. Ensure information system compliance (e.g., ensure that system security configuration guidelines are followed, compliance monitoring occurs) and verify that application hardware/software/network/system security postures are implemented as stated, document deviations, and recommend required actions to correct those deviations.

The Contractor shall provide an ATO Report for each package. This report shall include a list of ATOs supported, all required artifacts required for the Authorizing Official (AO) and VA's ATO processes as executed under IOAS requirements, all associated POAM details associated with the system, and the identification of risks and mitigations for the system, the assets making up the system, and the POAMs covered therein. The ATO Report shall be provided at the completion of the ATO package at least 15 days prior to the scheduled AO review date.

The Contractor shall ensure all artifacts are updated and maintained within the ATO package and be ready for leadership briefing and decision-ready for the Authorizing Official (AO):

- Infrastructure Operations RMF System Steward Weekly Report
- System registration and role assignments in GRC tool
- Security categorization documentation
- POA&M tracking and updates
- Workflow initiation and progress tracking
- Continuous monitoring status
- Stakeholder communication summary
- Security Artifact Documents
- System Security Plan (SSP)
- Hardware/Software Inventory Lists
- Risk Assessment Reports (NIST 800-30)
- Privacy Threshold Analysis (PTA)
- Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA)

- Incident Response Plan
- Configuration Management Plan
- Security Configuration Checklists
- Security Impact Analysis
- Authorizing Official Decision Briefs
- RMF Step Documentation

Deliverable
ATO Report

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
RMF system registration and record accuracy maintained.	100% of systems registered and records updated in GRC tool within required timelines defined by policy with confirmed accuracy.	100%	System Registration Records
Security categorization and control documentation completed.	100% of systems have accurate security categorization and documented controls based on VA's designation.	100%	Security Categorization Reports and Control Documentation
POA&M items tracked and maintained.	100% of POA&M items updated within SLA timeframes.	100%	POA&M Logs
RMF workflows initiated and managed.	100% of RMF steps executed and tracked in GRC tool.	100%	Workflow Status Reports
Continuous monitoring activities performed.	100% of supported systems monitored and compliance verified in accordance with the ATO, VA standards, and based on SLA requirements through active monitoring.	100%	Continuous Monitoring Reports
Stakeholder coordination and	100% of required communications	100%	Communication Logs

DRAFT

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
communication completed.	documented and delivered.		

5.2.2 KNOWN EXPLOITED VULNERABILITY (KEV) AND VULNERABILITY MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall provide KEV and Vulnerability management. VA classifies systems with the following boundary categories: Critical, Bedrock, and Principal. Each system boundary maintains an active asset list. The Contractor shall ensure systems within boundaries are evaluated against vulnerability data and the following actions occur with the system owners:

- Customer alerts
- Customer awareness
- Customer training
- Remediation and mitigation guidance
- Metric trending
- Assistance achieving positive cybersecurity maturity

The Contractor shall ensure that vulnerability management processes and tools are updated based on VA's active and future tools sets.

The Contractor shall recommend cybersecurity posture and KEV remediation by conducting evaluations and analyses. The Contractor shall ensure the following tasks are completed, tracked, and reported in a KEV scorecard:

- KEV identification and notification
- KEV and aged vulnerability trends
- Unauthorized application identification and notification
- End of support application identification and notification
- Quality and frequency of customer communications
- Credentialed scan health identification and notification

The Contractor shall provide active participation in team, customer, and ad-hoc meetings to ensure alignment and effective communication across all stakeholders. The Contractor shall also utilize organization-defined tools, such as MS SharePoint and MS Teams for project tracking. The Contractor shall use IO Action Items and ServiceNow (or equivalent) tickets as identified by Information Verification and Management System (IVMS).

Data viewed or accessed within this scope of work may contain sensitive information and business-related risks and shall not be shared external to VA in accordance with VA 6500 Handbook.

5.2.2.1 CYBERSECURITY POSTURE EVALUATION

The Contractor shall perform evaluations of boundary assets, identifying key cyber risk factors, report generation, and compiling data including at a minimum:

DRAFT

- Known Exploited Vulnerability (KEV) identification
- Trend of KEV remediation
- KEV age
- Action details for KEV remediation
- Timeline for KEV remediation
- Credentialed scan health
- Unauthorized applications
- End of support/end of life applications

The Contractor shall:

a. Perform comprehensive evaluations of cybersecurity posture for all assigned system boundaries and provide artifact evidence for each evaluation based on the following cadence:
   1. Bedrock and Critical systems require evaluations bi-monthly (twice monthly) or on demand / Ad-Hoc request based VA need.
   2. All other systems shall be evaluated monthly or on demand / Ad-Hoc request based on VA need.
b. Conduct weekly (or on demand / Ad-Hoc request based on VA need) comprehensive evaluations of cybersecurity posture for system boundaries with overdue KEV and provide artifact evidence of evaluation.
c. Perform KEV reviews within two business days on assigned system boundaries with artifact evidence, using Cybersecurity Operations Center (CSOC) vulnerability scan data or equivalent data set when published (or on demand / Ad-Hoc request based on VA need)

Deliverables:

- KEV Compliance Reports
- Vulnerability Trend Reports
- Application Identification Reports

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Detailed KEV Report	100% of findings are addressed in a plan of action with stakeholder concurrence.	100%	KEV Compliance Report and System Owner Confirmation
KEV remediation trend analysis	Monthly trend report delivered on time with accurate data.	100%	Vulnerability Trend Reports
Unauthorized and end-of-support applications identified and reported.	100% of unauthorized and outdated applications	100%	Application Identification Reports

DRAFT

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
	identified and documented.		

5.2.2.2 VA PARTNERSHIP ENGAGEMENT

The Contractor shall engage with VA stakeholders and/or System Owners to present recommendations regarding vulnerability management to improve customer understanding and impact of findings. Knowledge sharing and recommendations shall include at a minimum:

- Walkthroughs on reporting and risk evaluation components, such as:
  - KEV identification
  - Trend of KEV remediation
  - KEV age
  - Action details for KEV remediation
  - Timeline for KEV remediation
  - Credentialed scan health
  - Unauthorized applications
  - End of support/end of life applications
- Standard operating procedures
- Processes
- Tools

The Contractor shall:

A. Notify (via email and direct communication) system owners and related stakeholders of new KEV releases for affected systems boundaries within one business day of completing cyber risk evaluation. Provide KEV Notification Logs.
B. Notify (via email and direct communication) assigned boundary Directors, Information System Owners (ISO) and related stakeholders of KEV detections or discoveries within two business days of new scan data availability. Provide KEV Detection Notification Logs.
C. Engage in recurring customer partnership meetings with system boundary owners and affected stakeholders bi-monthly (twice monthly) and on demand / Ad-Hoc request based on VA need and provide Meeting Minutes and Engagement Reports. These should address the following at a minimum:
   - Boundary health
   - KEV status
   - Vulnerability management processes
   - Cybersecurity risks
   - Upcoming (or new) milestones for remediation actions
   - Next steps required to achieve (or maintain) reduced threat vectors
   - Identified cybersecurity gaps
   - Associated information
D. Notify system owners and related stakeholders via Trend Notification Reports of observed negative impact trends for all assigned system boundaries within three

DRAFT

business days of completing cyber risk evaluations consisting of the following elements at a minimum:

- Aged KEVs
- KEV impact increases
- Credentialed scan visibility health
- Unauthorized application installs
- Related cybersecurity trends that may highlight potential issues or roadblocks to achieving acceptable boundary health.

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Engagement improves cybersecurity posture and awareness.	95% of assigned systems and boundaries demonstrate an improved trend.	95%	KEV Compliance Report and Vulnerability Trend Report
Notification of new KEV releases provided within required timelines.	Notifications sent within 1 business day of KEV release.	100%	KEV Notification Logs
Notification of KEV detections from scan data provided within required timelines.	Notifications sent within 2 business days of new scan data availability.	100%	KEV Detection Notification Logs
Leadership awareness of enhanced, persistent, and/or prolonged cyber risks.	Notifications sent within 3 business days of completing cyber risk evaluations.	100%	Trend Notification Reports

5.2.2.3 VULNERABILITY MANAGEMENT SUPPORT

The Contractor shall maintain visibility and improve continuous monitoring for POA&M requirement awareness, ownership and key stakeholder identification (to include associated IO Director), asset-to-system boundary alignment (where needed), and other IO system boundary-related vulnerability support. The Contractor shall maintain continuous monitoring for ATO related cybersecurity risk – to include, at a minimum, sharing information and assist with preparation of pre-ATO cybersecurity risk evaluation. The Contractor shall:

a. Provide POA&M Awareness Reports that include overall cybersecurity risk data and POA&M requirement awareness (where applicable) to associated IO Director, ISO,

DRAFT

and impacted stakeholders (which may include other team members associated with the ATO process) at least 15 business days before assigned IO system boundary ATO review is due.

b. Support actions related to asset-to-system boundary alignment, system ownership identification, threat exposure identification or reporting, and associated customer communications within same business day of IVMS leadership request.
c. Follow-up and respond to assigned system boundary customer requests within one (1) business day via stakeholder interactions (meetings, email, etc.).

Deliverable:

- POA&M Awareness Reports

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
POA&M details highlighting risks and issues prior to ATO evaluation.	99% of risks and issues identified.	99%	POA&M Awareness Reports

5.2.2.4 CYBERSECURITY METRICS AND COMMUNICATIONS

The Contractor shall track and report data on improvements in all assigned IO system boundary cybersecurity risk posture (such as KEV and aged vulnerability reduction), improvements in credentialed scan success, and identify cybersecurity gaps. The Contractor shall document known key cyber risk factors which include, at a minimum, credentialed scan health, unauthorized applications, end of support/end of life applications, etc. Identify and capture in appropriate artifact milestones achieved and milestones yet to achieve, notate timelines and associated POA&Ms detailing timelines for future actions, and include trending data for key metrics.

a. Provide a concise and comprehensive Cybersecurity Metrics Report that includes (at a minimum) all in-scope vulnerability management support activities 100% of the time, on a cadence defined by IVMS leadership. This artifact shall highlight key trend metrics for areas such as (but not limited to) positive results, diminishing results, and potential stagnant areas
b. Partner with Cybersecurity Analysts to notify Directors, system owners and related stakeholders via KEV Notification Logs of new KEV releases for affected system boundaries within one business day.
c. Follow-up and respond to assigned system boundary customer requests within one business day.
d. Within same business day of IVMS leadership request, support actions related to asset-to-system boundary alignment, system ownership identification, threat exposure identification or reporting, and associated customer communications. Provide all details of the actions in the Alignment Support Logs.

Deliverables:

- KEV Notification Logs

DRAFT

- Alignment Support Logs

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Cybersecurity risk posture improvements tracked and reported.	100% of scheduled reports delivered on cadence defined by IVMS leadership.	100%	Cybersecurity Metrics Reports
Notification of new KEV releases provided within required timelines.	Notifications sent within 1 business day of KEV release.	100%	KEV Notification Logs
Customer requests responded to within required timelines.	Responses sent within 1 business day of request.	100%	Customer Request Response Logs
Support actions for asset-to-boundary alignment and threat exposure completed.	Actions supported within same business day of IVMS leadership request.	100%	Alignment Support Logs

5.2.3 ENTERPRISE COMMON CONTROL SOLUTIONS

The Contractor shall provide common control support to Enterprise Common Control Solutions (ECCS). These Controls shall be standardized, shared policies and procedures that satisfy multiple compliance frameworks (like NIST, ISO, Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard [PCI-DSS]) and risk requirements with a single implementation. This reduces redundancy and improves efficiency, with examples including access controls, data encryption, incident response, risk assessments, and audit logging, applied consistently across the organization for different frameworks. The ECCS acts as VA "control backbone," translating high-level governance into practical, repeatable actions for security and compliance

The Contractor shall provide technical expertise in defining, documenting and validating system control details, security and implementation information, artifacts, evidence, assessment procedures, and test results in the GRC tool for all ECCS managed information Systems of Record.

The Contractor shall comprehensively manage and update all Control Details, security, and configuration information for ECCS-managed systems of record in the GRC tool. The Contractor shall ensure that all Control Details are current and complete, security

DRAFT

and configuration information is consistently accurate and 100% of artifacts, evidence, assessment procedures, and test results are documented in the GRC tool.

The Contractor shall accurately author, maintain, and update required Common Control Security Artifact SOP's per the VA Knowledge Service Authorization SOP. These updated SOPs for each Common Control Security Artifact shall be provided on a quarterly basis.

The Contractor shall provide regular updates and revisions to ECCS based on changes in VA policies or systems, with no missed updates, shall ensure the timely coordination of updates ensuring all stakeholders are informed and aligned and that evidence artifacts from system stakeholders are collected and managed as per the VA Knowledge Service Authorization SOP.

The Contractor shall also collect and manage evidence artifacts from all relevant stakeholders, ensure the evidence artifacts are readily available for audits and reviews and are compliant with VA standards and procedures. These Security Artifacts include but not limited to policy documents, SOPs, screen captures. These security artifacts and implementation details for security controls shall be documented within the GRC tool and regularly validated and verified through RMF reviews, Security Control Assessments (SCA), and internal assessments to ensure completeness and accuracy.

The Contractor shall ensure all renewal and review timelines for Common Controls and Security Artifacts are met consistently including 100% adherence to established renewal and review schedules and proactive tracking and reporting on the status of reviews and renewals. The Contractor shall provide a review for each Common Controls and Security Artifacts on an annual basis. The review shall be required based on the expiration of the previous year's review. The Contractor shall provide a Monthly Artifact Review Report that includes details on each Artifact review completed a schedule for all planned reviews and status of each set of Artifacts.

The Contractor shall also ensure the GRC tool is complete and updated accurately based on RMF workflows and SOP timelines and validation is successfully performed during RMF reviews, SCAs, and internal assessments, with no discrepancies or missing information. The Contractor shall provide a Monthly RMF Validation Report that details the status of all RMF activities in the GRC Tool to include any issues.

Deliverables:

- Control Details
- Common Control Security Artifacts SOP's

Outcome	Key Performance Indicator (KPI)	Acceptable Quality Level (AQL)	Evidence of Success (Deliverable)
System details, security, and	100% of ECCS-managed	100%	GRC Tool

configuration information managed and updated in GRC tool.	systems have current and complete details documented.		
Security artifacts authored, maintained, and updated per VA SOP.	100% of artifacts updated accurately and on time with no missed updates.	100%	GRC Tool
Evidence artifacts collected and managed for audits and reviews.	100% of evidence artifacts available and compliant with VA standards.	100%	GRC Tool
Renewal and review timelines for common controls met consistently.	100% adherence to renewal and review schedules with proactive tracking.	100%	Renewal and Review Status Reports
GRC accurately reflects RMF workflows and SOP timelines.	100% of updates validated during RMF reviews and SCAs with no discrepancies.	100%	RMF Validation Reports

5.2.4 BUSINESS CONTINUITY MANAGEMENT PROGRAM PLANNING SUPPORT

The Contractor shall manage the Continuity Planning, Compliance and Preparedness efforts IO Managed Systems, ensuring each system is fully tested, staff trained, and exercised to achieve ATO authorization support. Critical functions and mission-essential operations are identified and prioritized to drive effective continuity planning and preparedness.

1. **Contingency Planning Development**

The Contractor shall:

- Manage continuity planning and preparedness efforts for approximately 110 IO Applications, including:
  - Providing and executing IT Disaster Recovery Contingency Plans and Continuity of Operations Plan (COOP) plans to the GRC Tool and the Plan Repository.
  - Coordinating applicable tabletop and functional tests, training, and exercises. The Contractor shall provide a Functional Test Report that includes all details of testing including results and recommendations.

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- Notify (via email and direct communication) system owners and related stakeholders of new application requirements for affected systems boundaries within one business day of completing cyber risk evaluations.
- Notify (via email and direct communication) assigned boundary Directors, Information System Owners (ISO) and related stakeholder's discoveries within two business days.
- Engagement shall recur on an annual basis and in the event of significant architectural changes to include but not limited to platform changes, hosting environment changes and product and/or vendor changes. The Contractor shall provide the following documents, at a minimum, including recurring customer partnership meetings with system boundary owners and affected stakeholders based on VA needs:
  - After Action Report
  - Deficiencies
  - Functional Test
  - Lack of Functional Test
  - Information System Contingency Plan (ISCP)
  - Business Impact Analysis (BIA)
  - Upcoming (or new) milestones for remediation actions
  - Identified cybersecurity gaps
  - Associated information
  - Track status and engagement in accordance with Business Continuity Management (BCM) processes
  - Provide Stakeholder Engagement Logs which shall include a running list of stakeholders that verifies meeting occurrence, testing plans and status.
  - Provide a Remediation Action Report that includes a plan for revalidation

- Coordinate all managed IO Franchise systems to ensure each is tested, trained, and exercised to guarantee operability during a continuity event.
- Following the COOP Planners Guidance documentation and updating that Guidance as needed.

- Identify, review, prioritize and provide BIA Documentation Reports including Mission Essential Functions (MEFs) and Primary Mission Essential Functions (PMEFs) for each IO Franchise System.
- Engage system stakeholders (System Owner (ISO), Application Manager, Project Manager, System Administrator, Business Office) to establish parameters for continuity planning. Provide Stakeholder Engagement Logs.
- Leverage VA-authorized information resources such as VA Configuration Management Database (CMDB), VA Systems Inventory (VASI), GRC, and adhere to applicable policies, handbooks, and procedures.

2. Alternate Workplace and Data Processing Location Management

The Contractor shall:

- Identify and designate alternate locations capable of supporting continued operations and command and control during disruption events.

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- Provide BCM-produced Contingency Plan to ensure alternate workplace and data processing locations are designated.
- Conduct annual testing and evaluation of the designated alternate locations to assess logistics, capacity, and security. Provide Annual Testing and Evaluation Reports.
- Provide Progress Reports and Exercise Plans detailing overall plan status management, forecast, issues, trends, and exercise planning for all applications in internal dashboards.
- Maintain and test an accountability roster and Veterans Affairs Enterprise Architecture and Application Services (VAEAAS) Notification System annually for each application. All information shall be included in Accountability Roster and Notification System Test Report.
- Provide a Final Application Disaster Recovery and COOP Scorecard that includes all plans including all BIA documentation, Alternate Location Designation Reports, test results and plans for full recovery.

3. Disaster Reconstitution Activity Support

The Contractor shall:

- Develop and execute reconstitution plans included in ISCPs and Disaster Recovery Plans (DRP) for approximately 110 applications to allow personnel to resume normal operations at designated locations.
- Collaborate with stakeholders (System Owner (ISO), Application Manager, Project Manager, System Administrator, Business Office) to ensure effective planning and execution of reconstitution activities.
- Utilize VA CMDB, VASI, Enterprise Mission Assurance Support Service (eMASS), email, and alerting and notification systems for disaster event activities ensuring all assigned plans and services are documented and managed per required controls.

Deliverables:

- Remediation Action Report
- Accountability Roster and Notification System Test Reports
- Continuity Planning Reports and Exercise Documentation
- Final Application Disaster Recovery Contingency Plan
- COOP Scorecard

Task/Outcome	Key Performance Indicator (KPI)	Acceptable Quality Level (AQL)	Evidence of Success
Service continuity is established for all supported systems	100% of systems have established COOP plans and DR processes defined.	100%	T Disaster Recovery Contingency Plans and COOP plans
Disaster recovery preparedness	100% of artifacts are recorded within the VA's	100%	Annual Testing and Evaluation

DRAFT

Task/Outcome	Key Performance Indicator (KPI)	Acceptable Quality Level (AQL)	Evidence of Success
procedure artifacts are synchronized with GRC documentation	GRC tool post completion of table-top and/or functional testing activity		Reports, GRC Tool, and After Action Reports
Validation of VA's service continuity through disaster recovery preparedness procedures	95% of all systems are validated against documented disaster recovery procedures through functional and/or table-top exercises at no less than annual basis	95%	After Action Reports and Lessons Learned artifacts

5.2.5 NETWORK SECURITY SERVICE (NSS)

The Contractor shall provide network security support services enabling deployment, tuning, configuration, optimization and visibility utilizing the identified and established solutions as mandated by VA's cybersecurity strategy, NIST, CISA and other federal requirements applicable to VA. Today those solutions include, but are not limited to, Cloudera, RedSeal, Armis, Forescout, Defender XDR and Sentinel, Netskope Secure Access Service Edge (SASE), Gigamon, Keysight Ixia, FireEye Malware Protection System (MPS), Palo Threat and Imperva Web Application Firewall (WAF).

These solutions provide visibility requirements, audit capabilities, cybersecurity, incident mitigations, risk aversion and incident containment across the VA Enterprise. This coverage applies to approximately 3,000,000 assets within the VA Enterprise consisting of all VA hosting locations asset types which include, at a minimum, datacenters, VA Medical Center (VAMC) locations, end user devices, servers, Internet of Things (IoT), mobile and other Internet Protocol (IP) addressed devices such as printers and Voice Over IP (VoIP) phones which utilize the VA network, and/or access VA data and services.

Due to the nature and visibility of these services, the Contractor shall maintain a high sensitivity across all configuration details, data collections, coverage areas, and cybersecurity related actions in accordance with VA 6500 Handbook. VA designated stakeholders and authorized parties will determine the activities, scope, and direction associated with the NSS solution behavior, integrations, and alignment. All actions supported by Contractor(s) shall be accomplished with minimal direction and direct actions by government employees. Collaboration between support teams, stakeholders, 3rd party vendors and/or Contractors, and other government officials as duties required to complete the task order.

Outcome Area	Key Performance Indicator (KPI)	Acceptable Quality Level (AQL)	Evidence of Success

Enhanced Visibility of assets, risks and controls.	Maintain 95% awareness of all assets, their configuration, compliance against VA standards and asset properties.	95%	Available asset coverage by solution indicating gaps in visibility or coverage, accurate and reduced asset detail, compliance data, hardware and software versions, system owner, and boundary alignments were applicable at a minimum
Reduce cybersecurity incidents through automated detections	5% increase in automated detections year over year.	5%	Solution Trend Analysis and FISMA audit report
Enhancements to VA security posture through optimization	100% month by month, recommend new security posture optimizations based on detection data, trend analysis and visibility	100%	Trend analysis, visibility reports and threat data

5.2.5.1 ARCHITECTURAL INTEGRATION

The Contractor shall provide architectural integration support for all current and future NSS solutions. This support shall include, but not be limited to, establishing network communications; maintaining network communications, infrastructure configurations; integration with enterprise systems through API's and other data exchange mechanisms; system connections; data flows; data retention requirements; and cybersecurity configuration expertise.

The Contractor shall:

- Support and contribute to stakeholder discussions that define at a minimum, solution requirements, interoperability with other solutions, data consumption, compliance, hosting requirements, level of effort, and scope.
- Deploy on-premises and cloud hosted environments and configurations therein relating to at a minimum virtual machine infrastructure, load balancers, virtual

DRAFT

networks, I/O levels, cost-per-use decision matrixing, database types, and datacenter equipment
- Configure API integrations between various technologies and solutions to the established and defined NSS solutions
- Provide recommendations for optimizing solution designs within scope of NSS to fulfill VA ECSO's cloud optimization requirements relating to cloud computing resources, database types and utilizations, communication throughput, and data storage
- Knowledge and understanding as to the various network layer actions, configurations, and behavior relating to cybersecurity solutions
- Script and code in multiple coding languages to include but not be limited to; YAML Ain't Markup Language (YAML), Python, PowerShell, Command Line Interface (CLI), Kusto Query Language (KQL), Data Analysis Expressions (DAX), Event Query Language (EQL), Serial Peripheral Interface (SPI), and Practical Extraction and Report Language (Perl) in order to build automation, routine actions through scripting, perform testing actions, report manipulation through direct SQL or equivalent database actions, and network activities
- Administrate, deploy, and the configure of Windows server 2017 through 2025, RedHat Enterprise Linux 8.0 through 10.0 or current versions
- Create, maintain, and document ATO artifacts necessary to implement solutions and maintain their ability to operate within the VA Enterprise network and directly interact with the IOAS team in remediating findings associated with the ATO package to include but not limited to architectural diagrams, data flows, and topology maps.
- Maintain connectivity and integration between NSS solutions and CSOC solutions, and VA's Enterprise Data Lake.
- Perform issue remediation, troubleshooting, identify solution failures, and respond to service outages.

5.2.5.2 CONFIGURATION AND TUNING

The Contractor shall create, manage, and optimize the NSS solution configurations and behavior to include but not limited to:
- Role-Based Access Control
- Permission Sets
- Security Groups
- Configuration Policies
- Alert Tuning
- False Positive Reduction
- Data enrichment through signal fidelity
- Solution Responses

The Contractor shall provide at a minimum:
- Create, utilize, and maintain Role-Based Access Configurations (RBACs) for NSS's solutions utilizing least privilege access and ensuring separation of duties through policies established by security groups

- Normalize data feeds across multiple solutions to ensure unique values are maintained while minimalizing duplication or misaligned data values
- Optimize data orchestration and retention for all NSS solution outputs prior to ingestion within the Enterprise Data Lake and other retention locations
- Optimize data flows ensuring the cost of the transaction is the lowest required to meet customer and stakeholder needs
- Create, implement and manage the solution configurations directing the solution's actions, behavior, or visibility in response to existing, new, and emerging cybersecurity threats
- Create and evaluate test cases to refine solution configurations impacting actions, behavior, and event generation
- Perform testing and validation of configuration, policy, and response action changes through pre-production and multiple production deployment groups to reduce risk and harm to VA assets, services, and solutions while adhering to VA's Change Management processes.
- Adjust policies and reporting actions to match VA baseline, compliance standards, cybersecurity threats, and coverage requirements.
- Recommendations on cybersecurity optimization through configuration, policy, and visibility within the NSS solutions
- Validation of configuration through regularly occurring testing to validate security control coverage, false positives, network segmentation control, data transmissions, integrations, and data fidelity.
- Validation of encryption requirements within the NSS solution, data transmission pathways, and storage locations
- Configuration deployment plans that include passive validations where possible when implementing within the production environment to reduce business operational impacts

5.2.5.3 NEW DEPLOYMENTS

The Contractor shall support the implementation of new solutions and the expansion of capabilities within existing NSS solutions. Support shall include conducting product evaluations, developing and validating use cases, assessing and supporting potential migration capabilities from pre-established solutions, and producing and maintaining deployment-related documentation including SOPs, knowledge articles, and user guides.

The Contractor shall:

- Support and contribute to stakeholder discussions that define at a minimum, solution requirements, interoperability with other solutions, data consumption, compliance, solutions constraints, capability gaps, hosting requirements, level of effort, and scope.
- Provide market research support including providing gaps in meeting scoped criteria for use, user ratings from similar sized environments to include other federal agencies, and evaluation criteria against defined requirements with defined recommendations for each product in scope of the review, and interactions and/or limitations with existing solutions

DRAFT

- Support with use case validation within each deployment zone to include lab environments, pre-production, limited production evaluations, and full production validations
- Provide a list of limitations preventing the migration of services or solutions from moving to the cloud.
- Provide readiness validation of solutions targeted for cloud migration under NSS purview on at least a monthly basis
- Define, document, and recommend schedules for actioning new deployments or expansion of capabilities
- Generate any new documentation required for the ATO package and deployment timelines for any new solution deployments or capabilities expansions to include SOPs, knowledge articles, and user guides where appropriate.
- Assess and document migration feasibility, constraints, risks, and readiness associated with transition existing or divested solutions including cloud migration.

5.2.5.4 DAY-TO-DAY OPERATION SUPPORT

The Contractor shall be responsible for providing day-to-day operational support for all current and future NSS solutions. This support shall include, but is not be limited to, addressing support tickets within VA's enterprise ticketing solution (historically averaging approximately 250 tickets per month for the entire service line); assigned tasks within VA's Jira platform or equivalent; change control activities; routine system upkeep such as patching; regularly occurring operational tasks such as reviewing solution events; maintaining platform performance and availability; continuous monitoring of system health indicators telemetry data review; security events; troubleshooting and resolving operational issues; ensuring data continuity and integrity; and preventative actions such as data archival or periodic restarts of system components.

The Contractor shall provide:

- Issue Remediation and Troubleshooting: Generate and track remediation and troubleshooting tickets within VA's enterprise ticketing solution, stakeholder support requests, and cybersecurity activities such as event queries and correlation.
- Data Availability and Integrity: Ensure the availability and integrity of solution data within dashboards, reports, and event queues for evaluation, configuration actions, trend analysis, and optimization opportunities.
- Data Integration Validation: Validate the integrity and delivery of data to supported and dependent systems, such as but not limited to: CSOC dashboards, Enterprise Data Lake, ServiceNow or equivalent, and cybersecurity event correlation solutions.
- API Integration Validation: Validate API integration functionality, performance, and efficiency.
- Solution Configuration Validation: Validate solution configurations to ensure indicators and/or triggers, response actions, and event detections are functioning as expected.

DRAFT

- Incident Escalation: Escalate potential cybersecurity incidents to the appropriate stakeholders within the expected timeframes defined within NSS SOPs and VA Cybersecurity SLAs.
- Patch Management: Manage patches for solution infrastructure, components, and software as approved by VA stakeholders within appropriate maintenance windows, and on an out-of-band and ad-hoc basis as directed by VA stakeholders.
- Policy and Configuration Deployments: Adjust configuration and solution behavior as directed by VA stakeholders.
- Solution Availability: Ensure system uptime meets NSS SOPs and SLAs through regular maintenance and necessary actions.
- Optimization Opportunities: Identify and report optimization opportunities to streamline processes, develop new processes, and reduce resource and cost implications for the NSS solutions through weekly and monthly reports to NSS leadership.
- Change Management Support: Support and participate in VA's change management process, including the creation of change management artifacts, providing Change Board briefings detailing the change, scheduling change implementation, and executing the change in both pre-production and production environments.
- Coverage Validation: Validate visibility coverage, including asset inventories and boundary alignments through solution integrations.
- Cybersecurity Event Interpretation: Accurately interpret cybersecurity events to properly identify false positives, indicators of compromise, lateral movement actions, and urgent threats that require escalation through direct inspection and peer review within NSS SLAs.
- Task and Action Automation: Automate tasks and solution actions in accordance with NSS stakeholder direction.
- Compliance Report Validation: Validate solution and compliance reports to identify outliers or areas of concern.
- Service Account Management: Manage service accounts and validate access to NSS solutions.

5.2.5.5 VISIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

The Contractor shall provide enterprise visibility and reporting capabilities across all current and future NSS solutions that enable operational response for issue resolution, telemetry data, pattern recognition, data integrity, incident awareness, cyber threat indicators, trend analysis, compliance levels, optimization opportunities, and areas of concern at a minimum. The Contractor shall provide this visibility using identified dashboards, reports, and briefings to VA stakeholders at the direction and approval of NSS leadership.

The Contractor shall provide:

- Asset Coverage and Visibility: Available asset coverage by solution, indicating gaps in visibility or coverage, accurate and reduced asset detail, compliance

DRAFT

data, hardware and software versions, system owner, and boundary alignments where applicable.

- Correlation of Assets and Detection: Asset to detection correlation based on solution scope and configuration details.
- Queryable Outputs: Queryable outputs and consolidation points used by various solutions, enabling filtering of events, criteria, and properties in a readable format viewable within dashboards, reports, and visual tables using available solutions.
- Data Manipulation: Manipulation of data at the request of VA stakeholders based on defined criteria or reporting needs aligned with VA's cybersecurity and audit requirements.
- On-Demand Reporting: On-demand reports, dashboards, and artifacts utilizing available solutions.
- Automation: Automation of reports, dashboards, and artifacts utilizing available solutions.
- Topology Diagrams: Topology diagrams indicating at a minimum: data flows, communication directions, storage locations, egress and ingress points, and solution boundaries through interoperability relationships.
- Incident and Event Reporting: Reports detailing cybersecurity incidents, event tracking, and attack surface potentials defined by searchable criteria, properties, and security controls.
- Scorecard Inputs: Scorecard input in the form of exportable reports to be used by IOAS, IVMS, and other IO teams for decision-making actions within the respective team.
- Audit Reports: Audit reports detailing visible assets, locations, configurations, access control data, connectivity, relationships, data flows, and security controls at a minimum on an automated and ad-hoc basis.
- Usage Reports: Provide usage reports on data volume, trend analysis, cost evaluations, and optimization opportunities of data storage location(s) and solution(s) on an automated schedule and ad-hoc basis.

5.3 CERTIFICATE MANAGEMENT/PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE

VA's PKI system operates with 99% availability and supports 22 million transactions over a 24-hour period with real time responses at 100 milliseconds or less in order to deliver secure reliable certificate lifecycle management across all VA systems. The Contractor shall ensure availability 24/7 to ensure incident responses are provided within defined SLAs. The Contractor shall provide operational and engineering support, proactive monitoring, and strategic optimization to maintain compliance with federal security standards. The Contractor shall execute existing redundancy and failover mechanisms to minimize downtime. The Contractor shall write scripts in Powershell, PERL, or Python (or equivalent) and modify configurations for the following, at a minimum:

- Certificate Authorities (CAs)
- Validation Authorities (VAs)
- OCSP responders
- Certificate Distribution Points (CDPs)

DRAFT

The Contractor shall monitor dashboards, troubleshoot incident logs, provide incident resolution, and suggest improvements. This shall be documented in the Weekly PKI Support Summary Report which shall also detail uptime.

The Contractor shall support Certificate Lifecycle Management to adhere to existing SLAs, including at a minimum:

- Facilitate issuance, validation, revocation, and retirement of digital certificates.
- Support both automated and manual processes for certificate lifecycle.
- Ensure validation requests are processed.

The Contractor shall document certificate activity logs and SLA compliance in the Weekly PKI Support Summary Report.

The Contractor shall ensure PKI operations comply with VA security standards and federal mandates (OMB, NIST) by providing all documentation required for VA's PKI ATO maintenance. The Contractor shall implement continuous monitoring and alerting for PKI components. The Contractor shall deliver documentation, artifacts, and security audit reports for ATO compliance on a monthly basis.

The Contractor shall monitor and respond to incidents by deploying real-time monitoring tools for PKI health and performance. The Contractor shall generate weekly performance reports with the following details:

- KEV identification and notification
- Vulnerability trends
- Unauthorized application alerts
- Credentialed scan health status

The Contractor shall provide technical support and engineering for the following activities:

- Troubleshooting end-user and applicant certificate issues.
- Linux-based OCSP responders, Certificate Revocation List (CRL) distribution points, Hardware Security Module (HSM).
- Validation Authorities and Simple Certificate Enrollment Protocol (SCEP) technology.
- RedHat Certificate System.
- Development and scripting (C, C++, Perl, Python, Java, CGI, Shell).
- Architectural design improvement recommendations for PKI modernization.
- Implement releases, patches, and hot fixes to be deployed after business hours as defined by the COR.

The Contractor shall adhere to Risk Management Change procedures by submitting change requests as well as backout plans, test validation criteria, and test results. Deviations shall be documented via corrective actions and governance approval.

Deliverables
PKI Weekly Summary Report

DRAFT

Monthly Availability Report
Security Compliance Package

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Maintain PKI system availability and reliability.	Achieve and maintain 99% PKI service availability measured monthly.	99%	Weekly PKI Support Summary Report and approved dashboards
Incidents are resolved based on established SLAs.	Meets SLA timelines 99% of the time.	99%	ServiceNow (or equivalent)
Optimizing efficiency of the PKI solution to minimize alert occurrence and impact	Minimum of 2 recommendation implemented for improving optimization	2 per year	Monitoring dashboards, alert logs, and incident response reports

5.4 WEB INFRASTRUCTURE AND ADMINISTRATION

WebOps provides web infrastructure support for VA websites that includes ensuring operational, secure, and up-to-date enterprise website hosting for web applications, handling day-to-day web administration, server support, and ongoing maintenance of the VA's existing web infrastructure. This includes configuring, updating, and troubleshooting both physical and virtual servers running Windows Server and Red Hat Linux; managing web servers such as Microsoft IIS and Apache; supporting database platforms like MS SQL and Oracle; and providing support for specialized applications and platforms, including Cold Fusion, TEAMSITE, Drupal, WordPress, and LISTSERV.

5.4.1 WEBOPS SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide system administration for VA web hosting (web farms) to ensure the enterprise web infrastructure's stability, reliability, and security. The Contractor shall perform comprehensive Web Operations (WebOps) services in order to maintain VA's uptime of 99.9%. The Contractor shall ensure the following activities are executed:

1. **Ongoing Administration and Technical Support, including:**
   - Routine Maintenance: Perform regular updates, patches, and backups for web servers (Windows Server, Red Hat Linux) and their components (IIS, Apache).
   - System Monitoring: Continuously monitor system performance and health 24 hours a day, 7 days a week (24X7) and implement proactive measures to prevent potential issues. The Contractor shall monitor ServiceNow (or equivalent) dashboards for real-time and historical performance trends and establish predefined performance thresholds to trigger automated investigations.

- Routine audits and performance reviews.
- Integration with incident response for swift remediation.
- Optimization and Security: Ensure server configurations and database environments (MS SQL, Oracle DB) are optimized for peak performance and secured against vulnerabilities.

2. Ticket Management, including

- Address service disruptions, resolve tickets and provide rapid response (within one hour of notification) during non-business hours of 6pm ET to 6:00am ET, and all-day Saturday and Sunday. The Contractor shall perform follow up activities with issuer of the ticket.
- Ensure 95% of change and incident tickets resolved within 48 hours.
- Provide after-hours monitoring and on-call personnel to address critical issues. All other issues shall be resolved the next business day.
- The Contractor shall implement and follow effective escalation processes to minimize downtime and ensure timely resolution of critical issues. Escalation process includes contacting the management POC and documenting the event per VA guidelines.

3. Web Content and System Integration Support

- Ensure backend systems remain stable during web content updates and promotions.
- Verify that updates do not adversely affect applications and that scripting and functionality (e.g., Cold Fusion, LISTSERV) operate as intended.

4. Maintenance and Documentation

- The Contractor shall develop and maintain documentation for all configurations, processes, and incident responses, ensuring clear and accessible information for all stakeholders. Documentation includes procedures for the updates and maintenance of equipment.

5. Scalability and Integration

- Enhance current capabilities with advanced scripting support and ensure integration with existing systems.
- Ensure new processes or changes are fully compatible and can be scaled as needed.

6. Data-Driven Insights and Continuous Improvement monthly reporting that includes:

- Improvement recommendations with timeframe
- Periodic stakeholder reviews leading to actionable recommendations.
- Functional automated alerts and notifications for preemptive issue mitigation.

Deliverables

System Uptime Reports
Ticket Resolution Reports

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Compliance and Security Reports
Continuous Improvement Report

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Maintain enterprise web infrastructure uptime.	System uptime at or above 99.9%.	99.9%	System Uptime Reports
Resolve tickets within SLA.	95% of change and incident tickets resolved within 48 hours.	95%	Ticket Resolution Reports
Maintain stakeholder satisfaction.	Net Promoter Score over 70.	70 points	ServiceNow (or equivalent) Survey Management

5.5 MIDDLEWARE SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide comprehensive middleware and file transfer administration services to ensure secure, reliable, and high-performing operations across VA's enterprise infrastructure. The Contractor will deliver system administration, application support, proactive monitoring, security patching, incident response, and disaster recovery activities to sustain mission-critical services and ensure compliance with VA security standards.

5.5.1 ORACLE WEBLOGIC MIDDLEWARE OPERATIONAL SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide system administration support to maintain 99.9% uptime on approximately 350 servers hosting Oracle WebLogic middleware for 35 applications. The Contractor shall provide application support and maintenance on all Weblogic, Websphere, Tomcat, Apache, Java, Java Messaging Services, Single Sign On Internal (SSOi), Single Source of Error (SSOe) including Authentication and Authorization. The Contractor shall execute the following during planned maintenance windows to minimize impact on uptime:

1. Operational Support:
(a) Software installation, configuration, integration, tuning, administration.
(b) Oracle Weblogic Application Servers and RHEL Webservers (or equivalent) maintenance.
(c) Continuous Readiness in Information Security Program (CRISP) patching to ensure all middleware components remain secure and compliant.
(d) Workload transition and optimization support for infrastructure migrations (i.e. on premise to cloud).

2. Deployment:
(a) Utilize Dynatrace, Splunk, and SolarWinds to provide continuous system monitoring and real-time alerting.

DRAFT

(b) Deploy applications, enhancements, bug fixes
(c) Support releases, sprint cycles, coordinated installs
(d) Install Oracle Weblogic, Websphere, Tomcat, Apache & Java Critical Patching, Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) certificate updates.
(e) Ensure that alerts are acknowledged and acted upon within customer driven SLA timeframes to maintain operational uptime.

3. Production & Disaster Recovery Support:
(a) Respond to Critical Performance Indicator/ High Priority Incident (CPI/HPI) calls submitted through ServiceNow and perform system monitoring and alerts response.
(b) Manage and execute scheduled/unscheduled changes, incidents, requests, security scan remediation.
(c) Provide performance tuning, enhancements, 24x7 on call incident response, application of patches, administrational tasks, and shut down and restart applications during needed downtimes in order to minimize business impact.
(d) Participate in DR table-top and functional exercises, Information System Contingency Plan (ISCP) updates, Proof-of-Concept, and best practice meetings.

Deliverables
System Uptime Reports
Alert Response and SLA Compliance Reports
Deployment Monitoring Reports
Disaster Recovery and Production Support Reports

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Oracle WebLogic middleware infrastructure Uptime.	System uptime remains at or above 99.9% for approximately 350 servers.	99.9%	System Uptime Reports
SLA compliance for alerts and incident response.	100% of alerts acknowledged and acted upon within SLA timeframes.	100%	Alert Response and SLA Compliance Reports
Deployment, upgrades, migrations, and monitoring	100% of actions completed during maintenance windows without service disruption.	100%	Upgrade and Patching Reports

5.5.2 MIDDLEWARE FILE TRANSFER SUPPORT
The Contractor shall provide systems administration support in order to maintain 99.9% uptime on approximately 20 applications hosting ServiceNow Integration Hub (or equivalent) which provide Managed File Transfer and monitoring of Connect Direct &

DRAFT

Secure File Transfer Protocol (SFTP) file transmissions in the VA infrastructure. The Contractor shall execute the following:

1. Middleware Management
(a) Configure and maintain in-house applications to manage both automated and ad hoc secure SFTP file transfers within the VA environment.
(b) Support the implementation of a centralized dashboard for real-time monitoring and tracking of all secure file transfers.

2. Continuous Security and Compliance
(a) Support the Continuous Readiness in Information Security Program (CRISP) by ensuring timely and effective patching of middleware and related components.
(b) Execute RHEL (or equivalent) migrations and perform software level updates/upgrades to maintain system compatibility, security, and performance.
(c) Document changes in a Change Report.

3. Monitoring and Alerting
(a) Utilize App Dynamics, Splunk, and SolarWinds for comprehensive system monitoring and real-time alerting to preemptively address potential issues.
(b) Respond and resolve alerts in accordance with SLAs to maintain service reliability.

Deliverables
System Uptime Reports
File Transfer Success Reports
Change Reports

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Maintain 99.9% uptime on 20 applications utilizing ServiceNow Integration Hub for Managed File Transfer and monitoring.	System uptime remains at or above 99.9% for all 20 applications.	99.9%	System Uptime Reports
Successful file delivery for secure SFTP and Connect Direct transmissions.	95% of file transfers completed successfully without errors.	95%	File Transfer Success Reports

5.6 APPLICATION VIRTUALIZATION

The Contractor shall support VA's Virtual Desktop and Applications services ensuring 99% availability and supporting approx. 12,000+ concurrent users daily between multiple Virtual Desktop Infrastructure technologies. Support services shall include

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triaging, troubleshooting, resolving, transferring, or escalating OIT ticketing system incidents and requests assigned to the Application Virtualization Service Line for support with Citrix and Azure Virtual Desktop. The Contractor shall also provide support for Citrix implementations, Citrix NetScaler, Citrix FAS, Citrix StoreFront, and Azure Virtual Desktop subscriptions, while responding to potential and opened major incidents.

The Contractor shall meet the following:

1. **First Line Ticket Resolution Services**
   a. Provide first line ticket resolution services, higher than the VA Enterprise Service Desk, Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays from 6:00am to 10:00pm Eastern time.
   b. See Attachment AS Support Systems Req't Draft – Li (1) Attachment VDA for ticket types and incident priority options.
   c. Ensure effective triaging, troubleshooting, resolution, transfer, or escalation of incidents and requests, meeting the 95% success rate requirement across multiple operating systems to include Windows OS, Macintosh OS, and Linux OS.

2. **System Administration Support**
   a. Provide comprehensive system administration support for Citrix and Azure Virtual Desktop environments, covering Citrix NetScaler, Citrix FAS, Citrix StoreFront, and Azure Virtual Desktop subscriptions.
      i. Citrix has five (5) subscriptions (3 for Azure and 2 for AWS). Azure Virtual Desktop has two (2) subscriptions (one in Government and one in Commercial)
   b. System Administration support shall also be provided Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays from 6:00am to 10:00pm Eastern time. The Contractor shall ensure availability 24 hours a day, 7 days per week (24/7) to ensure incident responses are provided within defined SLAs.
   c. See Attachment AS Support Systems Req't Draft – Li (1) Attachment VDA for ticket types and incident priority options.
   d. Perform critical administrative tasks including, but not limited to, system deployment and decommissions, system configuration and updates, and vulnerability management.
   e. Optimize the Control-Up or equivalent monitoring and operations management tool using scripts to ensure accurate and meaningful alerts and dashboards.
   f. Respond and take corrective action on approximately 55,000 weekly monitoring alerts and maintain optimal scripting configuration of monitoring tools to ensure accuracy and relevance of alerts.
      i. Utilize the ControlUp or equivalent monitoring and operations management tools along with ServiceNOW (or equivalent) ticketing system and respond promptly to system alerts, customer escalation tickets, and potential and opened major incidents.
      ii. Provide active participation in team, customer, and ad-hoc meetings to ensure alignment and effective communication across all

DRAFT

stakeholders. The Contractor shall also utilize organization-defined tools, such as MS Sharepoint, Jira, and MS Teams for project tracking. The Contractor shall use IO action items and ServiceNow (or equivalent) tickets as identified by Application Virtualization.

3. **Communication and Documentation**
   a. Provide a Weekly Performance Report that includes Weekly Ticket Handling Performance Report, Ticket Throughput & Timeliness Report, System Administration & Change Management Reports, Configuration and Patching Reports and Monitoring & Alert Response Reports (ControlUp/App Dynamics/Splunk/SolarWinds)
   b. Provide support to stakeholders for resolving incidents, providing SME technical expertise in Application Virtualization for VA projects and initiatives. Maintain clear and effective communication with stakeholders regarding SME support, incident status, resolution actions, and escalations.
   c. Document all incident and request handling activities in accordance with Information Technology Service Management (ITSM) Ticket Handling Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs).
   d. The Contractor shall achieve at least a 4.0 Customer satisfaction survey score, attain a Net Promoter Score (NPS) of over 800 and adhere to ITMS Ticket Handling SOP best practices to ensure high quality service delivery. The Contractor shall ensure at least 95% of OIT ticketing system incidents and requests are triaged, troubleshot, resolved, transferred, or escalated and shall track and report on the number of incidents and requests handled within the required timeframe. This information shall be provided in the Monthly Customer Satisfaction & NPS Reports.
   e. The Contractor shall respond and take corrective action on approximately all weekly monitoring alerts and maintain optimal scripting configuration of monitoring tools to ensure accuracy and relevance of alerts.
   f. The Contractor shall ensure all changes and configurations are reviewed and approved by Technology Management leadership, aligning with government standards and policies including OneVA TRM and VA Handbook 6500. The Contractor shall also regularly review performance metrics and operational reports to evaluate adherence to desired outcomes and required capabilities and conduct periodic audits of processes and procedures to ensure compliance with established best practices and SOPs. The Contractor shall provide a Compliance and Audit Report on a monthly basis. (OneVA TRM / VA Handbook 6500)

Deliverables
Customer Satisfaction & NPS Reports
Compliance and Audit Reports

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Triaging, troubleshooting, resolving, transferring,	95% of incidents and requests are handled within	95%	Weekly Performance Report

DRAFT

or escalating OIT ticketing system incidents and requests for VDA Service Line (Citrix and Azure Virtual Desktop).	required timeframe.		
Provide first line ticket resolution services above VA Enterprise Service Desk, approx. 12,000+ concurrent users daily	Tickets resolved or escalated per SOPs; volume handled meets weekly targets.	100%	Weekly Performance Report
Optimize ControlUp monitoring scripts and respond to approximately 55,000 weekly monitoring alerts promptly.	Alerts acknowledged and resolved within SLA; scripts optimized for accurate alerts.	100%	Weekly Performance Report
Achieve ≥4.0 Customer Satisfaction score and NPS > 800; adhere to ITMS SOP best practices.	Customer satisfaction and NPS targets met; compliance with SOP verified.	CSAT ≥4.0; NPS >800	Customer Satisfaction & NPS Reports

5.7 PRINTER SECURITY MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall provide enterprise Printer Security Management (PSM) services to maintain, monitor, remediate, and continuously improve the security posture of VA network-connected print devices within a decentralized, multi- Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) enterprise environment. These services shall support the VA's ability to sustain compliance with approved printer security baselines and prepare the enterprise for emerging requirements, including the enforcement of Simple Network Management Protocol version 3 (SNMPv3) and the deprecation of unsecure legacy protocols.

The Contractor shall provide operational and technical support for an estimated 80,000+ network-connected print devices across multiple OEM families and centralized OEM management platforms. Support shall include baseline enforcement, vulnerability/risk-based remediation, operational reporting, and protocol deprecation support.

Services shall be delivered utilizing experienced personnel, well-defined processes, and advanced tools, in close collaboration with VA stakeholders. These services shall be executed in alignment with VA cybersecurity policies, operational constraints, and enterprise change management practices.

DRAFT

The Contractor shall provide a Monthly Activity Report that summarizes operational activities and performance across the enterprise. The report shall include, at minimum:
- Monthly activity and tickets completed
- Total number of non-compliant devices remediated
- Summary of remediation actions performed (by OEM/tool family)
- Notable trends, constraints, recurring defects, and risk drivers
- Summary of open issues and recommended corrective priorities

The Contractor shall also provide a Monthly SNMP Migration Log / Protocol Transition Tracking Report. This Report is a standardized migration tracking log documenting SNMP-related transition actions, including:
- Devices migrated from SNMPv1/v2 to SNMPv3
- Devices identified as not capable of SNMPv3, including reason codes
- Migration/transition status (e.g., planned, in progress, completed, blocked)

The Contractor shall support all print devices spanning multiple OEM families and management platforms and perform the following:

1. **Baseline Configuration Management**

The Contractor shall apply, validate, and sustain compliance with VA-approved printer security baseline configurations across all in-scope devices. Baseline enforcement shall be accomplished through centralized OEM tools where feasible and through manual/remote configuration methods where required. Baseline activities shall include, at minimum:
- Verification of baseline configuration applicability by OEM and model family.
- Validation of baseline compliance status using available platform reporting mechanisms.
- Identification and remediation of noncompliant baseline settings.
- Documentation of exceptions, constraints, and remediation outcomes in the Monthly Activity Report.

2. **Centralized Management Tool Operations**

The Contractor shall operate and administer centralized OEM printer/device management tools used by the enterprise to discover, manage, and remediate printer security baseline configurations. Tools may include, but are not limited to:
- Hewlett-Packard (HP) Web Jetadmin
- Zebra Printer Profile Manager Enterprise
- Lexmark Markvision Enterprise
- Xerox CentreWare Web
- Ricoh Streamline NX

Tool operations shall include:
- Ensuring devices are discoverable, reachable, and properly managed in each platform
- Utilizing platform capabilities to identify noncompliance and apply corrective actions
- Coordinating tool-based remediation activities aligned to approved baseline settings

DRAFT

- Supporting troubleshooting efforts for device enrollment, credentialing, and manageability barriers
- Updates shall be detailed in the Monthly Activity Report.

3. Risk-Based Noncompliance Remediation

The Contractor shall monitor enterprise printer baseline compliance and remediate identified security deviations using a risk-based prioritization approach. Remediation shall include performing or coordinating required corrective actions and ensuring updates are documented and validated. Remediation tasks shall include:

a. Validation of reported noncompliance findings
b. Execution of corrective configuration changes
c. Verification testing to confirm remediation closure
d. Recording remediation outcomes in ServiceNow or VA-authorized tracking systems
e. Updates shall be detailed in the Monthly Activity Report.

4. Legacy Protocol Reduction and SNMPv3 Transition Support

The Contractor shall identify devices not capable of SNMPv3, document constraints (e.g., OEM limitation, model end-of-life, site network dependency), and provide recommended remediation paths including replacement, segmentation, or exception tracking. Progress and status of this shall be included in the Monthly SNMP Migration Log / Protocol Transition Tracking Report. The Contractor shall support VA initiatives to transition printer devices away from legacy or insecure protocols and configurations including, but not limited to:

a. Deprecation and elimination of SNMPv1 and SNMPv2 usage
b. Support for SNMPv3 enablement and validation
c. Coordination with stakeholders to align device configuration, credentialing, and connectivity requirements

5. Strategic Planning Support

The Contractor shall support PSM strategic planning efforts by providing data-driven input, device population insights, baseline maturity assessments, and recommended sustainment improvements based on observed trends.

- Provide detailed insights into the population and distribution of network-connected print devices across the VA enterprise.
- Conduct thorough assessments of current security baselines, identifying areas of strength and opportunities for improvement to ensure alignment with best practices and emerging security standards.
- Analyze observed trends and patterns in printer usage, security incidents, and compliance metrics to predict future requirements and challenges.
- Suggest targeted improvements and sustainment strategies based on trend analysis, threat intelligence, and the latest industry developments to enhance the overall security posture of VA's print device infrastructure.

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- Provide robust data and analytics to support informed decision-making, ensuring that strategic planning efforts are grounded in empirical evidence and aligned with broader VA cybersecurity and operational objectives.

Deliverables
Monthly Activity Report
Monthly SNMP Migration Log / Protocol Transition Tracking Report

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Maintain printer security baseline compliance across the enterprise using a risk-based remediation approach appropriate for a decentralized, multi-OEM	95% of reported non-compliant devices remediated within 30 days.	95%	Service Now tickets and Netaphor Site Audit reports.
Provide resolution of tickets	Resolution of assigned tickets within SLA timeframes	95%	Service Now tickets and Netaphor Site Audit reports.
Reduce the number of high-risk non-compliant printers across the enterprise.	10% reduction in high-risk findings quarter-over-quarter.	10% reduction	Monthly Activity Report, iCamp, and Netaphor Site Audit reports.

5.8 DATABASE ADMINISTRATION

The IO Database Management Service Line (DMSL) requires database administration services to support Oracle and SQL Server database applications hosted across VA on-premises infrastructure, Amazon Web Services (AWS), and Microsoft Azure environments. The Contractor shall provide infrastructure-level Database Administration (DBA) support for 10 Oracle and 8 SQL Server database applications of the total existing 75 applications. The number of applications may increase or decrease by up to 30% annually based on operational demand. For the remaining 57 database applications, the Contractor shall provide supplemental support to VA Personnel.

5.8.1 NORMAL SHIFT DATABASE ADMINISTRATION

The Contractor shall provide Database Administration support during normal shift hours (08:00-4:30 Central Time, Monday-Friday excluding Federal Holidays).

DRAFT

The Contractor shall implement real-time monitoring to detect and resolve issues. The Contractor shall implement and test disaster recovery plans to include failover and database restore, to achieve Recovery Time Objectives (RTO) and Recovery Point Objectives (RPO), minimizing downtime and data loss. The Contractor shall monitor and resolve issues to prevent outages. The Contractor shall insure no more than 2 database related critical incidents per quarter on supported systems.

The Contractor shall enhance query performance by optimizing scripts, tuning indexes, and analyzing execution plans, in times such as, when there are performance bottlenecks. The Contractor shall conduct regular health checks to ensure scalability and efficiency.

The Contractor shall implement security best practices and industry standards, to include but not limited to, encryption, and auditing to ensure protection of data and compliance with VA and Federal regulations. The Contractor shall document current and historical security configurations and audit trails.

The Contractor shall automate database management processes, to include deploying approved infrastructure-as-code (IaC) tools, automating routine tasks, and integrating database operations for deployments.

The Contractor shall implement changes following the OIT Change Management SOP. The Contractor shall ensure all artifacts are communicated to IO Database team leadership on the required schedule and stored in a central repository to be created and maintained by the contractor team.

- Daily end of shift reports to team leadership and the team.
- Weekly status updates to stakeholders.
- Monthly performance reports covering database health, incidents, changes, and improvements, including actionable insights and recommendations.
- Monthly Disaster Recovery Test Logs
- Quarterly Security Audit and Compliance Reports
- Monthly Performance Optimization Reports
- Monthly Automation and CI/CD Deployment Reports
- Monthly Backup and Recovery Validation Reports.
- Quarterly Capacity Forecast Reports.
- Monthly Incident Resolution Reports.
- Quarterly Stakeholder Satisfaction Surveys

Deliverable
Monthly Uptime/Availability Report

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence

DRAFT

Ensure high availability of databases	Database uptime	≥99.9% monthly availability	Monthly uptime dashboards/reports
Validate disaster recovery capability	DR test success; RTO/RPO attainment	100% annual failover test success; meet application RTO/RPO (Mission Critical RTO <12 hours, RPO <2 hours, Essential Support RTO<72 hours, RPO <24 hours, Routine Support RTO <30 days, RPO<24 hours)	DR test logs; validation reports
Maintain backup integrity and recoverability	Backup completion; recovery test success	99% daily backups (≥30-day retention); 100% monthly recovery success	Backup completion reports; restore validation logs
Resolve incidents within SLA	Mean Time to Resolution (MTTR)	Critical ≤4 hrs (day) / ≤2 hrs (after-hours); non-critical ≤24 hrs	ServiceNow incident and SLA compliance reports
Optimize database performance	Query performance; resource utilization	>95% queries meet baseline post-change; utilization within thresholds. 15% query performance increase optimization requested by supported application.	Performance tuning reports; query benchmarks; monitoring dashboards
Execute upgrades/migrations seamlessly	Migration downtime; data integrity; rollback validation	<1% downtime; 100% data accuracy; rollback plans validated pre-migration; query performance ≥95% at or above pre-migration measured	Migration validation report; rollback plan approval

DRAFT

		within 2 weeks of migration.	
Automate operations and deployments	CI/CD success; automation error rate	≥95% successful deployments; <1% automation errors	CI/CD pipeline reports; automation logs
Capacity planning and scalability	Forecast accuracy; workload scalability	≥90% forecast accuracy; sustain 20–50% workload increase without degradation	Quarterly capacity planning reports
Governance and documentation	Documentation completeness; reporting cadence	100% of critical docs within 3 months; daily/weekly/monthly reports on time	Documentation updates; daily EoS; weekly status; monthly performance

5.8.2 AFTER HOURS DATABASE ADMINISTRATION

The Contractor shall provide after-hours database administration (DBA) support services for database platforms under the purview of the IO Database Team, including Microsoft SQL Server and Oracle Database environments hosted across on-premises infrastructure, Amazon Web Services (AWS), and Microsoft Azure. These services will ensure system availability, optimal performance, and robust security through outage monitoring, break/fix response, proactive maintenance, and vulnerability patching. Support shall also extend to Database Platform-as-a-Service (DB PaaS) solutions as VA project teams modernize their applications. The need is for support of an initial count of seventy-five (75) database applications, with capacity to scale ±30%, across MSSQL, Oracle, and DB PaaS environments depending on operational demand.

Afterhours support coverage shall include:

- 2nd Shift: 8:00pm – 1:30am Central Time
- 3rd Shift: 1:00am – 8:30am Central Time
- Weekends and Federal holidays

The Contractor shall implement and maintain real-time monitoring systems for all IO-supported MSSQL and Oracle instances, databases, and servers using VA-approved tools including Dynatrace, Oracle Enterprise Manager, and SolarWinds Orion. Note toolsets are subject to change. The Contractor shall develop and execute initial triage processes to categorize incidents by severity and impact. The Contractor shall utilize the IO Database callback escalation process to promptly escalate issues requiring additional expertise beyond standard break/fix efforts and ensure effective communication channels for seamless escalation.

DRAFT

The Contractor shall implement a structured schedule for regular patching and updates during off-peak hours and monitor implementation to ensure no adverse impact to system functionality. The Contractor shall deliver daily end-of-shift reports summarizing changes, incidents, alerts, and backup failures, including Change Requests, ServiceNow incidents, Commvault backup failures, and WHEN mailbox alerts processed. The Contractor shall ensure all artifacts are updated and communicated to the IO Database Leadership Team according to the schedule listed per item.

- Weekly After-Hours Coverage Schedule & Staffing Reports
- Monthly Availability & Uptime Reports.
- Weekly Break/Fix & Escalation Logs
- Monthly Patching & Change Management Compliance Reports.
- Daily summaries of changes, incidents, and alerts.
- Monthly Vulnerability Remediation Progress Reports
- Quarterly Monitoring Tool Dashboards implementation & Alert Handling Evidence.

Deliverables

- After-Hours Coverage Schedule & Staffing Reports
- Monthly availability and uptime reports
- Quarterly Platform Coverage Reports

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Maintain system availability	Database uptime	≥ 99.9% monthly uptime	Monthly availability & uptime reports
Detect and respond to incidents promptly	Incident detection and response time	Critical: ≤ 15 mins; Non-critical: ≤ 2 hrs	Incident detection & response SLA reports
Resolve critical incidents quickly	Incident resolution time	≥ 95% resolved within 2 hrs unless escalated	Break/Fix actions & escalation logs
Minimize escalations	Escalation handling efficacy	Resolve ≥ 95% of WHEN incidents without escalation; escalate unresolved issues within 1 hr	Escalation logs; callback records
Apply vulnerability patches on schedule	Patching compliance rate	Successfully patch ≥ 70% of vulnerabilities before next report	Patching & change management compliance reports
Ensure patch stability	Post-patch success	≥ 90% of patched systems exhibit no issues	Post-patch validation reports

DRAFT

5.9 OPERATIONS CONTROL/CONSOLIDATED MAIL OUTPATIENT PHARMACY (OC/CMOP)

The Contractor shall provide enterprise-level support for VA's pharmacy and operations systems to ensure secure, reliable, and uninterrupted services that enable critical healthcare and communication functions. This includes sustaining database environments for national and regional pharmacy operations, supporting secure data exchange and print workflows, and collaborating with VA teams to maintain compliance, optimize performance, and adapt to evolving technology needs. The Contractor will deliver proactive monitoring, incident response, and operational continuity to uphold VA's mission of serving Veterans efficiently and securely.

5.9.1 CMOP DATABASE SUPPORT

The Contractor shall support Consolidated Mail Outpatient Pharmacy (CMOP) Pharmaceutical Service (CPS) to ensure performance, integrity, and security of a database and ensure 99.9% uptime for databases during production hours. The Contractor shall support and maintain custom, proprietary databases for each of the seven regional CMOP sites and the CMOP National systems. The Contractor shall support roughly 700 databases that have approximately 5,000-7,000 users daily.
The Contractor shall work with both CMOP Regional staff and CMOP National staff to collaborate, support, and recommend improvements at both Regional and National CMOP systems. The Contractor shall provide support during normal operating hours and provide 24x7 on call incident response.

Pharmacy Sites	Location	Normal Operating Hours
760 Shawnee CMOP	Shawnee, KS	6:00AM-4:00PM (CT)*
761 Chelmsford CMOP	Chelmsford, MA	5:30AM-3:00PM (ET)
762 Tucson CMOP	Tucson, AZ	6:00AM-12:00AM (MT)
763 Dallas CMOP	Lancaster, TX	6:00AM-12:00AM (CT)
764 Murfreesboro CMOP	Murfreesboro, TN	6:30AM-5:00 PM (CT)
765 Hines CMOP	Chicago, IL	5:00AM-12:00AM (CT)
766 Charleston CMOP	Ladson, SC	5:30AM-12:00 AM (ET)
770 CMOP Pharmaceutical System	Tucson, AZ	6:00AM-4:00PM (CT)

*This will be changing to 6:00AM-12:00AM (CST) after Q3 2026.

The Contractor shall perform the following:

1. Database Availability and Uptime - Provide continuous, uninterrupted access to databases, minimizing downtime and ensuring operational continuity.
2. Support - Provide DBA support to oversee and manage database installation, configuration, compliance, upgrades, performance monitoring, optimization and tuning, capacity planning, database design and development, data migration, back-up and recovery, security implementation, and documentation.
3. Manage custom CMOP databases – Manage and maintain custom CMOP databases, application processes, stored procedures, and applications across all regional and national sites.

DRAFT

4. Provide support and comprehensive documentation for database users, system owners, and business owners for Regional and National sites - Provide support to data analysts, software developers, and CMOP software users, and document all database metadata, applications, and reports.
5. Database maintenance and patching - Support regional and national CMOP organizations with database patching, maintenance, and modifications as needed. Ensure CMOP databases remain secure, up-to-date, and optimized.
6. Accuracy of pharmacy transactions – Ensure patient safety and system integrity.
7. Change management and outage prevention - Ensure all database updates follow proper change management protocols and do not cause outages. Provide smooth transitions and updates without disrupting pharmacy operations.
8. Remediation of Database Findings - Ensure no recurring database findings and remediate all findings within required timeframes according to the SLA's. Provide continuous improvement and compliance with VA Security and Performance Standards.
9. System Monitoring and Alerting – Utilize Dynatrace, Splunk, and SolarWinds for monitoring and alerting to provide proactive identification and resolution of potential issues, maintaining system performance.
10. Service NOW Ticket Resolution - Resolve tickets for database-related issues, ensuring minimal disruption to services.

Deliverables
CMOP Database Helpdesk Weekly Report (per site)
CMOP Database Support Weekly Report (per site)
Uptime & Availability Reports
Change Management & Patch Compliance Reports
Accuracy & Transaction Integrity Reports
Findings Remediation Reports
ServiceNow Ticket Resolution Reports
On-Call Coverage Logs

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Ensure 99.9% uptime during production hours across CMOP regional and national databases.	Achieve 99.9% uptime during production hours with minimal downtime.	99.9%	Uptime & Availability Reports
Ensure 100% accuracy of pharmacy transactions.	Zero errors in pharmacy transactions ensuring patient safety.	100%	Accuracy & Transaction Integrity Reports
Follow change management protocols to prevent outages.	99.9% availability during change implementation; all	100%	Change Management & Patch

DRAFT

	changes documented.		Compliance Reports
Deployment, upgrades, migrations, and monitoring	100% of actions completed during maintenance windows without service disruption.	100%	Change Management & Patch Compliance Reports
Remediate database findings within SLA timeframes and prevent recurrence.	All findings remediated within SLA.	100%	Nessus scans
Provide after-hours on-call coverage	Coverage provided as scheduled; incidents handled within ServiceNow SLAs.	100%	On-Call Coverage Logs

5.9.2 OPERATIONS CONTROL

The Contractor shall provide specialized technical and operational support to Operations Control (OC), including Print and Mail Operations support, database workflow support for Production Print Operations (PPO) and OC integrated systems, and Managed File Transfer (MFT) architecture, integration, and monitoring. The Contractor shall adapt processes, tooling, reporting, and technical approach, as needed, to continue meeting the performance requirements.

5.9.2.1 PRINT AND MAIL OPERATIONS SUPPORT

The Contractor shall support Mail and Print Operations at the Hines Information Technology Center (HITC), ensuring the accurate, timely, and secure delivery of communications to Veterans and beneficiaries. Annually, this operation supports the production of more than 40 million printed pages and the mailing of approximately 11 million letters. Printing volumes vary based on seasonal demand, one-time initiatives, and high-visibility program requirements. The Contractor shall support variable production volumes while maintaining consistent quality, timeliness, and prioritization of urgent workload in accordance with Government-defined processing schedules. The Contractor shall adapt accordingly to ensure uninterrupted support.

The Contractor shall provide proper coverage during Government-defined scheduled production. These coverage periods are established based on operational workload, system availability, and mission priorities, and may be adjusted by the Government as Print and Mail operations evolve. Any adjustments will be made with reasonable advance notice when practicable and are not intended to fluctuate on a day-to-day basis. Staffing coverage may include hands-on production activities, operational monitoring, quality oversight, data validation, job preparation, workflow coordination, and other supporting functions aligned with the end-to-end print and mail process. Operational models may evolve to include potential shifts toward increased automation, centralized monitoring, and greater use of external print vendors. Specific equipment,

DRAFT

tooling, and operational approaches may change in support of efficiency, cost, modernization, and mission needs.

The current Mail and Print Operations infrastructure at HITC includes, but is not limited to:

- Large-scale digital production printers (e.g., Xerox Nuvera 157 running on Xerox FreeFlow Print Server)
- Automated mail inserters (e.g., Bell & Howell Phillipsburg Mailstar running on JETVision)
- High-speed output finishing equipment for postcard and specialty mail production

The Contractor shall be responsible for meeting the defined performance outcomes and service levels. The Government, through the COR, will communicate when operational demand or performance indicators require adjustment to ensure continued compliance with contract outcomes. The Contractor shall be responsible for scaling operational capacity, workflows, automation, and internal resource allocation.

Operational demand drivers may include, but are not limited to:

- Increased annual mail piece and page volumes beyond historical baselines
- Expansion of time-sensitive or high-priority communications
- Introduction of new document types, layouts, or compliance requirements
- Changes in production scheduling models or coverage windows
- Increased coordination with external print, presort, or delivery vendors.

The Contractor shall:

1. Operate, monitor, and maintain print and mail production systems, including high-speed printers, inserters, folders/sorters, and associated peripheral equipment.
2. Execute end-to-end print and mail production activities, including printing, inserting, traying, palletizing, and preparing mail for presort vendor pickup and USPS delivery.
3. Coordinate production scheduling coverage.
4. Monitor and validate print accuracy, mail integrity, and production throughput, identifying and correcting errors, defects, or process deviations.
5. Record, reconcile, and validate piece counts and job metrics at the start and end of each scheduled production time period and production job to ensure accountability and auditability.
6. Diagnose, document, and resolve equipment, workflow, and system-related issues, including opening and tracking vendor support tickets and documenting corrective actions.
7. Coordinate preventive maintenance, restoration activities, and system recoveries in alignment with operational schedules and vendor guidance.
8. Manage operating supplies and inventory levels, including paper, envelopes, inserts, and shipping materials.
9. Maintain a clean, orderly, and compliant production environment in accordance with Government safety, security, and facility requirements, including coordination of waste disposal and recycling activities.

DRAFT

10. Support IT-enabled print and mail workflows, including interaction with file transfer systems, job tracking applications, barcoding solutions, and print file validation processes used to support production and external vendor handoff.
11. Document and maintain SOPs, workflows, and contingency procedures, updating documentation when new failure modes, corrective actions, or system changes are identified.
12. Support modernization and automation initiatives, including adoption of enhanced barcoding, electronic viewing, file-based process improvements, and Government-directed technology enhancements.
13. Execute and document periodic contingency and recovery drills (e.g., equipment failover, reroute, degraded-mode operations) in accordance with Government-approved procedures.

Collectively, the Contractor shall capture the above in the following formal deliverables:

- Spoilage Reports - Tossed printed mail pieces, errors in print files printed, any others that cause spoilage.
- Scheduled Print & Mail Production & Job Count Reports - Piece counts recorded at job and schedule production coverage periods (start/end).
- Monthly Reports - Mail Piece Counts, Foreign Mail Counts, Special shipping Costs, Image Counts, Simplex/Duplex Counts
- Corrective Action Log / Trend Summary – recurring issues (equipment, workflow, systems, process), corrective actions taken, and trend summaries aligned to KPI impacts.

Artifacts

The following artifacts are produced on a continuous basis to support operational visibility, performance management, and system reliability. These artifacts are maintained internally and made available via dashboards, logs, or repositories.

- Daily Production Summary - Pieces printed, inserted, mailed by job and system.
- Weekly Operations Summary - Timeliness, backlog volumes, exception trends.
- Equipment Maintenance Summary - Uptime, incidents, corrective actions.
- Ticket Status Summary Logs – incident, timestamps, vendor engagement, and resolution details.
- Presort Vendor Summary - Documentation of mail rejected or unable to be processed by presort vendor.
- Quality & Accuracy Status - Error counts, rework volumes.
- Production Exception Register – list of late jobs, rejects, reprints, root cause, corrective action.
- Coverage, Backlog & Cycle Time Dashboard Extracts - coverage confirmation by production period, backlog age, queue position, receipt/print/insert/pickup timestamps, and priority category.
- Rework/Reprint Register - rework reason codes, quantity, job ID linkage, corrective action reference.
- Contingency Drill Log & After-Action Notes - drill scenario, success criteria, results, corrective actions.

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Deliverables
Spoilage Reports
Scheduled Print & Mail Production & Job Count Reports
Monthly Reports
Corrective Action Log / Trend Summary

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Timely production	On-Time Completion Rate = (Jobs Completed On Time ÷ Jobs Scheduled) × 100	≥97%	Production Reports
Print accuracy	Accuracy Rate = (Accurate Pieces ÷ Total Pieces Produced) × 100	≥99.99%	Quality Reports
Operational Coverage Compliance	(Covered Production Schedule ÷ Scheduled Production) × 100	100%	Coverage Logs
Equipment reliability	Equipment SLA Compliance = (Issues Resolved Within SLA ÷ Total Incidents) × 100	≥95%	Maintenance Logs
Training readiness	Training Completion = (Completed ÷ Required Trainings) × 100	100%	Training Records
Timely equipment incident response	Incident Response Compliance Rate = (Incidents Meeting Response Timelines ÷	≥95%	Incident logs, vendor ticket timestamps, Government Authority notifications

DRAFT

	Total Incidents) × 100 (Response timelines defined by operational procedures or vendor support agreements)		
Protection of PII/PHI	Privacy Compliance Rate = (Compliant Jobs ÷ Jobs Reviewed) × 100	100%	Inserter logs, count logs, privacy incident reports
Operational readiness	Training Execution Rate = (Completed Training Events ÷ Scheduled Events) × 100	100%	Training attendance & curriculum reports
Backlog managed within threshold	Backlog Age Compliance Rate = (Backlog Jobs with Age ≤ Government-Defined Threshold ÷ Total Backlog Jobs) × 100	≥ 95%	Production queue report + job timestamps + backlog register
Cycle Time Compliance Rate	(Jobs Meeting Government-Defined Cycle Time Threshold ÷ Total Jobs Completed) × 100 (Cycle time measured from job receipt to mail pickup or Government-defined completion point)	≥ 95%	Job tracking dashboard; job receipt timestamp; completion/pickup timestamp

DRAFT

Rework/Spoilage Rate	((Reworked Pieces + Spoiled Pieces) ÷ Total Pieces Produced) × 100	≤ 1%	Spoilage logs + quality reports + reprint register
Contingency Drill Success Rate	(Successful Drills ÷ Drills Executed) × 100	100%	drill records, after-action notes

Government-defined thresholds (e.g., backlog age limits and priority tiers) will be documented in Government-approved operating procedures/runbooks and may be updated as workload patterns and production models evolve.

5.9.2.2 DATABASE SUPPORT FOR PPO & OC INTEGRATED SYSTEMS

The Contractor shall provide coordination, verification/validation, integrations, reporting, and operational readiness for database-dependent workflows supporting PPO and OC systems. Database platform ownership and execution of core DBA lifecycle functions (e.g., patching, upgrades, backups, disaster recovery execution) remain the responsibility of the IO Database Group. The Contractor shall support reporting and workflow visibility that consumes Government-approved outputs from vendor-managed print workflow systems, without assuming responsibility for vendor-internal database logic or vendor-managed processing.

The Contractor shall:

1. Coordinate with the IO Database Group to support database platforms enabling PPO, OC, and Print & Mail systems, including lifecycle activities, configuration alignment, and integration readiness.
2. Monitor database availability, performance indicators, and capacity trends relevant to PPO and OC workflows to identify risks impacting production operations.
3. Analyze database-related performance metrics and support approved performance optimization recommendations in coordination with IO and application teams.
4. Coordinate and validate database-related data structure changes required for Government-approved integrations and reporting (e.g., schema update coordination and downstream impact validation) with system owners and the IO Database Group.
5. Develop and optimize SQL-based queries and analytics supporting reporting, troubleshooting, and operational visibility.
6. Support adoption and integration of VA-approved automation and low-code platforms, including Visual Basic, and Visual Basic for Applications (VBA), where they complement governance, integrations, security, and tenant controls.
7. Coordinate scheduled database maintenance activities (including communication, impact assessments, and post-maintenance validation) with the IO Database Group and affected stakeholders, in accordance with approved change management procedures, while execution responsibility remains with the IO Database Group.
8. Support backup, restore, and disaster recovery outcomes provided by the IO Database Group as they relate to application availability and operational readiness.

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9. Support triage and resolution of database-related incidents and internal PPO applications.
10. Support database security alignment by assisting with access reviews, audit preparation, and compliance evidence.
11. Support change management activities by preparing documentation, impact assessments, and coordination artifact.
12. Support maintenance of operational documentation, including data flow references, integration dependencies, and recovery coordination procedures.
13. Provide technical consultation to application teams, system administrators, analysts, and Government personnel.
14. Use approved scripting and reporting methods to automate routine validation, reporting extracts, and operational visibility needed to support KPI measurement and incident troubleshooting.
15. Support database-backed reporting and visibility outputs that provide job intake status, processing status, and reconciliation reporting for print workflows, using Government-approved integration outputs and available logging sources.
16. Troubleshoot database-related issues impacting integrated print workflow visibility by coordinating with vendors and internal stakeholders, and by validating data handoffs and reporting outputs within Government-controlled integration points.
17. Support onboarding or modification of external print destinations by updating Government-controlled integration references and validation artifacts (e.g., endpoint metadata, reporting mappings, monitoring hooks), without assuming ownership of vendor-internal routing logic.
18. Maintain a Government-accessible inventory of database dependencies, integrations, service accounts, and data flow maps.

Collectively, the Contractor shall capture the above in the following formal deliverables:

- Monthly Database Operations Report - Consolidated summary of availability percentages, downtime minutes, capacity utilization, performance trends, and notable operational events.
- Incident & Root Cause Analysis (RCA) Reports - Formal RCA documentation for Priority 1 and Priority 2 database-related incidents, including cause, impact, corrective actions, and prevention measures.
- Approved Change & Maintenance Documentation - Change requests, approval records, implementation summaries, post-change validation evidence, and rollback documentation where applicable.
- Backup & Disaster Recovery Test Reports - Formal reports documenting test scope, execution dates, success or failure results, and corrective actions.
- Security & Audit Evidence Packages - Documentation supporting database security assessments, audits, compliance reviews, and remediation activities.
- Database Technical Documentation Packages - Approved schemas, architecture diagrams, runbooks, recovery procedures, and data flow documentation.

Artifacts

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The following artifacts are produced on a continuous basis to support operational visibility, performance management, and system reliability. These artifacts are maintained internally and made available via dashboards, logs, or repositories.

- Database Operations Summary - Availability status, uptime indicators, active alerts, and operational health metrics.
- Database Performance & Capacity Summary - Resource utilization trends, performance thresholds, query execution indicators, and growth patterns.
- Incident Tracking & Resolution Logs - Database-related incidents, timestamps, actions taken, escalation details, and resolution status.
- Change & Maintenance Activity Logs - Executed changes, maintenance windows, outcomes, and rollback indicators.
- Backup & Recovery Status Logs - Backup job completion status, restore validation outcomes, and recovery test evidence where available.
- Security Control Status Summary - Database security control posture, findings, remediation tracking, and compliance indicators.
- Integrated Workflow Visibility Summary - Integrated job intake status, processing status, retry indicators, reconciliation checkpoints, and downstream vendor handoff visibility.
- Vendor Integration Configuration Records - Integration configuration references supporting onboarding, modification, or removal of external print vendors and destinations.
- Operational Documentation Repository - Current runbooks, recovery procedures, data flow references, and configuration standards.
- Integration Dependency Inventory & Data Flow Map – Government-controlled integrations, upstream/downstream systems, reporting dependencies, service accounts, authentication methods, owners, approval references, and transition-relevant documentation.

Deliverables
Monthly Database Operations Report
Incident & Root Cause Analysis (RCA) Reports
Approved Change & Maintenance Documentation
Backup & Disaster Recovery Test Reports
Security & Audit Evidence Packages
Database Technical Documentation Packages

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
High availability of database services supporting PPO and OC workflows	Database Availability (Consumed Services) = ((Total Production Minutes – Unplanned Downtime) ÷ Total Production Minutes) × 100	≥99.9% during production hours	IO Database Group availability report **and/or** approved monitoring dashboard extract + outage ticket records

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Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Timely incident resolution	Incident SLA Compliance = (Incidents Resolved Within SLA ÷ Total SLA Incidents) × 100 (SLA definitions governed by operational procedures and support agreements)	≥95%	Incident Tickets & RCA Reports
RCA Timeliness Rate	(Priority Incidents With RCA Delivered Within Government-Defined Threshold ÷ Total Priority Incidents Requiring RCA) × 100	≥95%	RCA deliverables; incident ticket timestamps
Effective coordination of database-related changes	Change Coordination Success Rate = (Approved Changes Implemented Without Rollback ÷ Total Coordinated Changes) × 100	100%	Change & Maintenance Activity Logs
Validated recoverability of database services supporting PPO and OC	DR Validation Success Rate = (Validated Successful Tests ÷ Tests Reviewed) × 100	100%	Backup & DR Test Reports
Security compliance	Security Compliance Rate = (Compliant Systems ÷ Systems Assessed) × 100	100%	Security & Audit Artifacts
Optimized database performance	Performance Threshold Compliance Rate = (Performance Metrics Within Defined Thresholds ÷ Total Metrics	≥95%	Database Performance Reports

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Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
	Measured) × 100 *(Thresholds defined by operational baselines or system requirements)*		
Reliable and predictable maintenance execution	Maintenance Completion Rate = (Maintenance Activities Completed as Scheduled ÷ Maintenance Activities Scheduled) × 100	100%	Maintenance Schedules & Completion Logs
Operational continuity through accurate documentation	Documentation Currency Rate = (Approved & Current Documents ÷ Required Documents) × 100	100%	Documentation Inventory & Review Records
Reliable integrated workflow visibility and reporting	Integrated Workflow Record Availability Rate = (Integrated Job Records Successfully Received or Rendered in Government-approved reporting ÷ Total Expected Job Records) × 100	≥99.5%	Integration reporting outputs; job logs where available; reconciliation extracts
Coordination Response Compliance	(Requests acknowledged within X business hours ÷ Total Requests) × 100	≥ 95%	Ticket timestamps; email/Teams records; change records

Note: “X business hours” acknowledgement thresholds and priority categories will be defined in Government-approved operating procedures/runbooks and may be updated as operational needs evolve.

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5.9.2.3 MANAGED FILE TRANSFER (MFT) SYSTEM / SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & SUPPORT

MFT provides the secure, reliable, and auditable exchange of electronic files required to execute VA mission operations. These file transfers enable the movement of Veteran-related information, benefits data, correspondence content, forms, documents, and other records necessary to deliver services, benefits, and official communications to Veterans and their eligible family members. Within OC, MFT supports file-based workflows that span internal VA systems, Print and Mail Operations, and approved external partners. These transfers underpin downstream processing where controlled, traceable, and policy-compliant data movement is required, including time-sensitive Veteran-facing actions such as benefit notifications, eligibility determinations, and mailed correspondence.

The architecture supporting MFT is designed to be modular and adaptable, allowing underlying transfer engines, orchestration platforms, and monitoring components to evolve without requiring redevelopment of end-to-end workflows. This approach supports continuity of operations as enterprise platforms, tools, and architectural standards change over the period of performance, while maintaining reliability, observability, and auditability of file transfer activities. MFT solutions consist of multiple transfer mechanisms, integration patterns, and orchestration models that enable secure data movement across heterogeneous platforms and environments.

The Contractor shall support Enterprise Service Management (ESM) and Platform Team distributed development models by providing support capable of operating within Government-defined Distributed Development frameworks. All Distributed Development activities shall be performed in accordance with Distributed Development governance, onboarding requirements, role expectations, and SDLC controls, as amended over time. Support includes collaboration with Government ESM, Platform, and Product teams to align backlog intake, development sequencing, environment usage, testing coordination, release planning, and operational handoff, without assuming ownership of enterprise platforms, governance functions, or lifecycle management responsibilities unless explicitly directed by the Government.

Platform and integration changes may include, but is not limited to:

- Expansion of ServiceNow-based orchestration, workflow automation, and Integration Hub usage
- Increased Managed File Transfer transaction volume, routing complexity, and endpoint diversity
- Introduction of new file-based or API-based integrations supporting OC, PPO, or enterprise systems
- Adoption of additional enterprise monitoring, logging, and analytics platforms
- Increased use of automation and low-code platforms (e.g., Power Platform) to enhance operational visibility, reconciliation, or workflow enablement
- Migration, consolidation, or replacement of underlying transfer engines or integration components

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- Integration of additional work management, ticketing, and delivery tools (e.g., Jira or successor platforms) to support intake, backlog control, release coordination, and operational reporting, without assuming ownership of enterprise work management platforms unless directed by the Government
- Expansion into additional enterprise endpoints, protocols, identity patterns, and authorization models (e.g., API gateways, message services, service principals, token-based auth, or new SSO patterns) as VA-approved architectures evolve

The Contractor shall:

1. Design, maintain, and evolve system and software architecture for MFT, ServiceNow, and enterprise integration platforms, ensuring scalability, security, and operational alignment.
2. Produce and maintain architecture diagrams, technical standards, integration patterns, and implementation guidance supporting approved platforms and workflows.
3. Review proposed system changes, integrations, and enhancements for architectural compliance, technical risk, and operational impact.
4. Configure, operate, and support MFT solutions, including NearStar, SFTP-based services, and successor technologies.
5. Monitor MFT transaction success rates, file delivery performance, retries, and failures to ensure reliable end-to-end transfer operations.
6. Support integration models where ServiceNow or successor platforms act as orchestration and control points for inbound and outbound file transfer workflows with underlying transfer engines operating as integrated components.
7. Design, deploy, and govern ServiceNow workflows, integrations, and automation capabilities supporting operational, reporting, and orchestration use cases.
8. Implement and support ServiceNow Integration Hub, Flow Designer, authentication mechanisms, and middleware components required for secure system-to-system communication.
9. Support adoption and integration of VA-approved automation and low-code platforms, including Microsoft Power Platform.
10. Monitor integration health, workflow execution, and automation performance across supported platforms.
11. Provide incident response, troubleshooting, and root cause analysis activities for MFT, ServiceNow integrations, and automation workflows.
12. Execute system changes, enhancements, and releases in accordance with established change and release management procedures.
13. Provide knowledge transfer and mentoring to VA personnel on architecture standards, supported platforms, integrations, and operational best practices.
14. Maintain and update operational runbooks, technical standards, knowledge artifacts, and continuity documentation.
15. Support integration with enterprise monitoring and analytics platforms by enabling log ingestion, event correlation, alerting, and operational visibility for MFT, ServiceNow, and integration workflows.

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16. Maintain and update monitoring and event rules and priority classifications for MFT and orchestration workflows (e.g., critical endpoints, priority events, alert routing, escalation paths).
17. Maintain a integration inventory and dependency map for MFT and orchestration workflows (endpoints, protocols, owners, auth type, SLAs, monitoring hooks, data classification).
18. Perform and document post-deployment validation for releases (including monitoring checks and production verification) for a Government-defined stabilization window.
19. Support parallel development, configuration, integration, testing, and release activities across multiple teams, systems, and value streams using VA-approved development, work management, and DevOps tools (e.g., ServiceNow, Integration Hub, Power Platform, Jira, source control, CI/CD pipelines, and successor platforms).

Collectively these activities will be formally captured in the following specific deliverables:

- Monthly MFT Performance Summary - Aggregated monthly metrics including transfer volumes, success rates, retry trends, latency patterns, notable failures, and operational outliers.
- Architecture & Design Deliverables - Approved architecture diagrams, technical standards, integration patterns, and implementation guidance supporting enterprise MFT and ServiceNow platforms.
- Deployment & Change Management Deliverables - Formal documentation of Government-approved changes, including implementation results, validation outcomes, and rollback summaries.
- Incident & Root Cause Analysis Deliverables - Detailed RCA documentation for Priority incidents involving MFT, integrations, or automation workflows, including remediation actions and prevention recommendations.
- Training & Knowledge Transfer Deliverables - Architecture guides, platform overviews, and formal knowledge transfer materials provided to VA personnel.
- Integration & Automation Performance Deliverables - Leadership-level summaries highlighting integration reliability, workflow performance trends, growth patterns, and systemic risks.
- Enterprise Monitoring & Observability Summary - Periodic leadership-level summaries highlighting system health, transfer reliability, notable incidents, and compliance-relevant trends across MFT and integration services.
- Integration Inventory & Dependency Map Export (On Request) - current snapshot suitable for transition support and audits.
- MFT / Integration Capacity & Risk Plan (Quarterly, or on request) – forward-looking summary of known onboarding and release commitments provided by the Government, active risks, dependency constraints, and mitigation actions to sustain KPI performance and delivery timelines.

Artifacts

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The following artifacts are produced on a continuous basis to support operational visibility, performance management, and system reliability. These artifacts shall be maintained internally and made available via dashboards, logs, or repositories.

- MFT Operations Dashboard Submissions - Transfer volumes, success/failure counts, retry activity, latency indicators, and operational status.
- Integration & Workflow Health Summaries - Execution success rates, failure trends, availability indicators for ServiceNow workflows and integrations.
- Architecture Reference Artifacts - Current-state and target-state diagrams, integration patterns, and platform standards maintained as living documentation.
- Change & Deployment Tracking Logs - Records of approved system changes, deployments, release activities, and implementation outcomes.
- Incident & RCA Tracking Summaries - Incident records, timestamps, affected integrations, root cause categorizations, and corrective actions.
- Training & Mentorship Logs - Records of mentoring sessions, walkthroughs, and knowledge transfer activities.
- Runbooks & Operational Knowledge Artifacts - Operational procedures, troubleshooting guides, continuity documentation, and standards updates.
- Operational Monitoring & Analytics Summaries – Aggregated views derived from ServiceNow, MFT platforms, and Government-approved monitoring tools, including workflow execution metrics, incident trends, SLA status, and audit-relevant logs.
- Integration Inventory & Dependency Map - endpoints, protocols, owners, auth type, SLAs, monitoring hooks, data classification.
- Notification & Escalation Log Extracts - alert time, incident time, notify time, recipients/bridge details, acknowledgement time, and closure.

Deliverables

Monthly MFT Performance Summary
Architecture & Design Deliverables.
Deployment & Change Management Deliverables
Incident & Root Cause Analysis Deliverables
Training & Knowledge Transfer Deliverables
Integration & Automation Performance Deliverables
Enterprise Monitoring & Observability Summary
Integration Inventory & Dependency Map Export (On Request)
MFT / Integration Capacity & Risk Plan (Quarterly, or on request)

Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Reliable file transfer	File Transfer Success Rate = (Successful Transfers ÷ Initiated Transfers) × 100	≥99.5%	Monthly MFT Performance Report

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Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
	(Includes all Government-approved MFT paths and orchestrated workflows)		
Architecture compliance	Architecture Compliance Rate = (Approved Implementations ÷ Reviewed Implementations) × 100	100%	Architecture Review Records
Successful deployments	Deployment Success Rate = (Deployments Without Rollback ÷ Total Deployments) × 100	≥95%	Change & Deployment Logs
SLA compliance	Ticket SLA Compliance = (Tickets Resolved Within SLA ÷ Total SLA Tickets) × 100 *(as defined by Government-approved SLAs)*	≥95%	ServiceNow Reports
Knowledge sustainability	Knowledge Artifact Completion = (Completed ÷ Required Artifacts) × 100	100%	Training & Knowledge Records
Reliable integration and workflow execution	Integration Availability Rate = ((Total Scheduled Execution Time – Unplanned Downtime) ÷ Total Scheduled Execution Time) × 100	≥99.5%	ServiceNow Workflow & Integration Availability Reports

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Outcome	KPI	AQL	Evidence
Stable and resilient MFT and integration operations	Repeat Incident Rate = (Repeat Incidents ÷ Total Incidents) × 100	≤5%	Incident Trend & RCA Reports
Effective knowledge transfer and operational readiness	Training Effectiveness Rate = (Staff Demonstrating Operational Proficiency ÷ Staff Trained) × 100	≥95%	Training Assessments & Mentoring Records
Timely detection and notification of priority events	Detection & Notification Compliance Rate = (Priority events notified within threshold ÷ Total priority events) × 100	≥ 95%	Monitoring alert timestamps + ServiceNow incident create time + notification logs (email/Teams/phone bridge records where applicable)
Controlled release quality and minimized regression	Post-Deployment Defect Rate = (Incidents Attributable to a Change Within Stabilization Window ÷ Total Deployments) × 100	≤ 5%	ServiceNow incident-to-change linkage + deployment logs + RCA notes where applicable
Timely root cause analysis and corrective action	RCA Timeliness Rate = (Priority Incidents With RCA Delivered Within Threshold ÷ Total Priority Incidents Requiring RCA) × 100	≥95%	RCA deliverables + incident tickets + timestamps

6.0 TASK ORDER PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall provide program management support to accomplish the administrative, managerial, logistical, integration and financial aspects (Program,

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Planning, Budget and Execution [PPBE]) specified in this task order. The Contractor shall support project/product management functions and reporting which include, but are not limited to:

A. Project Planning
B. Schedule Management
C. Financial Management
D. Earned Value Management (EVM)
E. Quality Management
F. Resource Management
G. Requirements Management
H. Communications Management
I. Project Change Management
J. Organizational Change Management
K. Risk Management
L. Performance Management
M. Knowledge Management (KM)
N. Scope Management
O. Stakeholder Management

7.0 SURGE SUPPORT (OPTIONAL TASK)

The Contractor shall provide additional resources in cases where traditional resource levels cannot meet an increase in systems, policy, threats exceed current scale of support in a PWS task area. The Contractor shall provide flexible and scalable support to accommodate surge requirements, unplanned growth, and emerging strategic objectives. This includes the rapid deployment of qualified personnel, tools, and processes to meet evolving mission needs without disruption to ongoing operations. The Contractor shall ensure responsiveness, continuity, and alignment with organizational priorities during periods of increased demand or strategic shifts. At the end of the surge support period, the Contractor shall conduct post-performance surveys with stakeholders to identify a satisfaction level based on a five-star rating assessment. The Contractor shall include the ability for comments and use that feedback mechanism to identify improvements in Contractor performance.

The Contractor shall:

- Maintain readiness to scale support services within 10 business days of notification.
- Support the integration of new strategic objectives into existing workflows and reporting structures.
- Ensure continuity of operations during periods of transition, growth, or reorganization.
- Collaborate with stakeholders to assess needs, define priorities, and implement responsive solutions.
- Track and report on surge activities, resource utilization, and outcomes.

Deliverables
Surge Readiness and Response Logs
Surge Staffing and Resource Utilization Reports

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Strategic Integration Plans and Updates
Continuity of Operations Reports
Monthly Surge and Flex Support Activity Reports
Stakeholder Feedback and Satisfaction Summaries

Outcome	**Key Performance Indicator (KPI)**	**Acceptable Quality Level (AQL)**	**Evidence of Success (Deliverable)**
Surge readiness maintained	Response capability within 10 business days of option exercise	99%	Onboarding timeframe
Strategic integration effectiveness	New objectives integrated into all IO domains	95%	Strategic Integration Plans and Logs
Stakeholder satisfaction	4 out of 5 Stars average at the end of the task order performance period.	4 out of 5 Stars	Stakeholder Feedback Summaries

8.0 GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

8.1 SECURITY AND PRIVACY REQUIREMENTS

In accordance with VA Handbook 0710, Personnel Security and Suitability Program, the position sensitivity and the level of background investigation commensurate with the required level of access for the following tasks within the PWS are:

Position Sensitivity and Background Investigation Requirements by Task

Task Number	**Tier1 / Low Risk**	**Tier 2 / Moderate Risk**	**Tier 4 / High Risk**
5.1	☐	☐	☐
5.2	☐	☐	☐
5.3	☐	☐	☐
5.4	☐	☐	☐
5.5	☐	☐	☐
5.6	☐	☐	☐
5.7	☐	☐	☐
5.7	☐	☐	☐
5.9	☐	☐	☐

The Tasks identified above and the resulting Position Sensitivity and Background Investigation requirements identify, in effect, the Background Investigation requirements for Contractor individuals, based upon the tasks the particular Contractor individual will be working. The submitted Contractor Staff Roster must indicate the required

DRAFT

Background Investigation Level for each Contractor individual based upon the tasks the Contractor individual will be working, in accordance with their submitted proposal.

8.2 GOVERNMENT FURNISHED PROPERTY

Based upon the Government assessment of remote access solutions and requirements of this effort, the Government estimates that the following GFE will be required by this effort:

1. **<Qty>** laptops

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